

The Record of Jesus Christ

Pure evidentiary claim index

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Claims: 606 · Tiers: {"well_attested":248,"verified":216,"contested":48,"interpretive":64,"speculative":2,"literary_theological":3,"circumstantial":1}

Every claim is labeled by evidence tier. Proof-grade data is never conflated with literary or theological development. This PDF is a portable index; the live platform at veritasworldwide.com/record-of-jesus-christ remains the canonical interactive surface.

Methodology (summary)

Tiers: Verified · Well-Attested · Circumstantial · Contested · Interpretive · Speculative · Literary/Theological. Tools: multiple attestation, Nestle-Aland/UBS standards, archaeological dating with ranges, observational cosmology as science only.

[well_attested] ane-amarna-habiru

Amarna letters mention Ḫapiru/Habiru groups in Late Bronze Canaan — sociopolitical ethnonym for “Hebrews.”

[verified] ane-amarna-letters

The Amarna letters (14th c. BCE) document Late Bronze Canaanite-Egyptian diplomacy and conflict language used in comparative ANE historical method.

[well_attested] ane-annals-shoshenq

Shoshenq I (biblical Shishak) campaign reliefs at Karnak list Levantine toponyms relevant to 10th-century BCE geopolitics debates.

[verified] ane-arad-ostraca

The Arad ostraca (Iron Age Judah) are primary Hebrew administrative/military correspondence documenting fort supply, names, and YHWH-related greetings in a border fortress context.

[verified] ane-babylonian-chronicle-597

The Babylonian Chronicle records Nebuchadnezzar’s 597 BCE capture of Jerusalem and installation of a new king — primary cuneiform control for the first Judean deportation horizon.

[verified] ane-babylonian-chronicle-jerusalem

Babylonian Chronicle entries record Nebuchadnezzar’s campaigns against Judah, including the 597 BCE deportation horizon.

[verified] ane-babylonian-chronicles

Babylonian Chronicles document Nebuchadnezzar’s campaigns against Jerusalem, providing independent chronological control for the late Iron Age Judah narrative.

[verified] ane-black-obelisk

The Black Obelisk of Shalmaneser III depicts Jehu (or a representative) of Israel paying tribute — an extra-biblical visual control for the Omride/Jehu period.

[verified] ane-black-obelisk-jehu

The Black Obelisk of Shalmaneser III depicts Jehu (or envoy) of Israel paying tribute — a primary visual control for 9th-century Israelite kingship.

[verified] ane-black-obelisk-jehu-detail

The Black Obelisk of Shalmaneser III depicts a kneeling figure labeled as of Jehu of Israel paying tribute — a rare visual control for 9th-century Israelite kingship.

[contested] ane-bulla-baruch

Clay bullae naming “Berekyahu son of Neriyaahu the scribe” (Baruch) are widely discussed as epigraphic controls for late-monarchic Judahite administration and the Jeremiah tradition’s scribal milieu.

[contested] ane-bullae-gedalyahu

Bullae naming Gedaliah and related officials are discussed as possible epigraphic controls for late Judahite administration around the Babylonian crisis (with authenticity depending on provenance).

[verified] ane-city-david-bullae-context

Hundreds of clay bullae and seal impressions from controlled City of David / Ophel excavations document late Iron Age Judahite administrative literacy and onomastics.

[well_attested] ane-cos-corpus

The Context of Scripture (COS) and ANET anthologies assemble primary ANE texts used as comparative controls for Hebrew Bible literature and historiography.

[verified] ane-cyrus-cylinder

The Cyrus Cylinder (c. 539 BCE) records Achaemenid policy of restoring temples and returning displaced populations after the conquest of Babylon.

[verified] ane-cyrus-cylinder-policy

The Cyrus Cylinder documents Achaemenid policy language of temple restoration and population returns; it is not a verbatim Ezra decree.

[well_attested] ane-cyrus-cylinder-policy-limits

The Cyrus Cylinder’s temple-restoration and return language is Achaemenid royal ideology; it is not a verbatim decree matching Ezra’s wording line-for-line.

[well_attested] ane-deir-alla

The Deir Alla inscription mentions Balaam son of Beor — a rare extra-biblical onomastic parallel to Numbers 22–24 traditions.

[verified] ane-ekron-inscription

The Ekron royal dedicatory inscription names Philistine rulers and a temple of Ptgyh — primary control for Iron Age Philistine urban religion and politics.

[verified] ane-elephantine-passover-papyrus

Elephantine papyri include correspondence about observing Passover/Unleavened Bread under Persian administration — primary evidence for diaspora Jewish festival practice in the 5th century BCE.

[contested] ane-exodus-historicity

The historicity and scale of an Israelite exodus from Egypt remain contested in critical scholarship.

[well_attested] ane-flood-literature

Mesopotamian flood traditions (Atrahasis, Gilgamesh XI) are independent literary parallels to Genesis flood narrative forms.

[well_attested] ane-gezer-calendar

The Gezer calendar is an early Hebrew agricultural calendar inscription relevant to literacy and agrarian life in the southern Levant.

[well_attested] ane-hezekiah-bulla

Bullae and seals naming Hezekiah (and debated related officials) provide epigraphic controls for late-8th-century Judah’s royal administration.

[verified] ane-hezekiah-bulla-provenanced

A provenanced bulla reading “Belonging to Hezekiah [son of] Ahaz king of Judah” from controlled Ophel excavations is a primary royal seal impression of late-8th-century Judah.

[well_attested] ane-hezekiah-lmlk

lmlk jar handles and related Judahite administrative seals concentrate in late eighth-century contexts associated with Hezekiah’s reign and Assyrian threat.

[verified] ane-hezekiah-lmlk-distribution

Spatial distribution of lmlk jar handles concentrates in late-8th-century Judahite sites, supporting royal administrative networks under Assyrian pressure.

[verified] ane-hezekiah-tunnel-inscription-language

The Siloam Tunnel inscription’s Hebrew narrative describes the breakthrough meeting of two work crews — primary linguistic evidence for late-8th-century Judahite Hebrew in a royal engineering context.

[verified] ane-hezekiah-tunnel-water

Hezekiah’s tunnel redirected Gihon spring water to the Siloam Pool — verified hydraulic engineering of late-8th-century Jerusalem.

[well_attested] ane-inscription-map

Key West Semitic and Egyptian inscriptions relevant to Israel/Judah (Merneptah, Mesha, Tel Dan, Siloam, etc.) form a geographically distributed control set across Egypt, Transjordan, and the Galilee–Golan.

[verified] ane-jehoiachin-rations

Babylonian administrative tablets record oil rations for “Ya’u-k+nu, king of the land of Judah” — primary cuneiform control for 2 Kings 25:27–30.

[verified] ane-ketef-hinnom

Ketef Hinnom silver scrolls contain early Hebrew priestly blessing text (Numbers 6) — among the oldest biblical text witnesses in metal.

[well_attested] ane-khirbet-qeiyafa

Khirbet Qeiyafa (Judah/Shephelah, early Iron Age) is a fortified site whose dating and political affiliation are central to debates on the 10th-century BCE Judahite state.

[well_attested] ane-kuntillet-ajrud

Inscriptions from Kuntillet ‘Ajrud include blessing formulae pairing Yahweh with other divine names — key data for Israelite religion debates.

[contested] ane-kuntillet-yhwh-asherah

Kuntillet ‘Ajrud inscriptions include blessings “by YHWH ... and his asherah” — contested evidence for Israelite religion’s diversity of divine associations.

[verified] ane-lachish-letters

The Lachish ostraca (letters) are late-Iron-Age Hebrew administrative/military correspondence relevant to Judah’s final decades before the Babylonian destruction.

[verified] ane-lachish-reliefs

Sennacherib’s Lachish reliefs (British Museum) depict the 701 BCE siege visually, complementing annals and biblical narratives.

[verified] ane-lmlk-iconography

lmlk jar handles carry royal iconography (scarab/winged sun variants) and place-name stamps — primary visual-administrative evidence for late-8th-century Judah.

[verified] ane-lmlk-jar-handles

lmlk (“belonging to the king”) jar handles from late-8th-century Judah form a large administrative ceramic corpus associated with Hezekiah-era preparation against Assyria.

[verified] ane-merneptah

The Merneptah Stele (c. 1208 BCE) contains the earliest known extra-biblical reference to “Israel” as a people in Canaan.

[verified] ane-merneptah-israel

The Merneptah Stele (c. 1208 BCE) contains the earliest widely accepted extra-biblical mention of “Israel” as a people in Canaan.

[well_attested] ane-merneptah-people-not-city

On the Merneptah Stele, “Israel” is marked with the determinative for a people/group rather than a city-state — a primary Egyptian classification detail in the earliest extra-biblical Israel reference.

[verified] ane-mesha

The Mesha Stele (c. 840 BCE) names Omri of Israel, Yahweh, and Moabite campaigns paralleling 2 Kings 3.

[verified] ane-mesha-line-by-line

The Mesha Stele’s narrative lines describe Moabite revolt against Israel and cultic acts including reference to vessels of YHWH — primary Moabite royal propaganda requiring line-level critical reading.

[verified] ane-mesha-yhwh

The Mesha Stele mentions YHWH in a Moabite royal context — primary evidence for the divine name outside the Hebrew Bible.

[verified] ane-moabite-stone-context

The Mesha Stele (Moabite Stone) remains a primary control for Omride-period geopolitics and Yahwistic onomastics in Transjordan.

[well_attested] ane-ophel-inscription-fragment

Hebrew inscription fragments from the Ophel excavations (including early alphabetic pieces) contribute to debates on literacy and administration in Iron Age Jerusalem.

[verified] ane-samaria-ostraca

The Samaria ostraca (Iron Age Israel) are primary Hebrew administrative dockets recording wine/oil deliveries and personal names in the Northern Kingdom capital region.

[verified] ane-sargon-samaria-fall

Assyrian royal inscriptions (Sargon II and related annals) claim the conquest of Samaria and deportations in the late 8th century BCE — primary imperial controls for the fall of the Northern Kingdom.

[verified] ane-sennacherib

Sennacherib’s annals (Taylor Prism / related prisms) describe the 701 BCE campaign against Judah and Hezekiah’s tribute without claiming Jerusalem’s capture.

[verified] ane-sennacherib-prism-tribute

Sennacherib prisms claim Hezekiah was shut up “like a bird in a cage” and paid tribute — Assyrian framing of 701 BCE without claiming Jerusalem’s capture.

[verified] ane-siloam-inscription

The Siloam Tunnel inscription (Jerusalem) is a primary Hebrew epigraphic witness associated with Hezekiah’s water system construction narrative.

[verified] ane-siloam-pool-context

The Pool of Siloam area in Jerusalem is archaeologically associated with water systems fed by Hezekiah’s tunnel — primary urban-hydraulic context for Iron Age and later city life.

[verified] ane-siloam-tunnel-engineering

Hezekiah’s tunnel engineering is archaeologically verified; the Siloam inscription describes the breakthrough meeting of two work crews.

[well_attested] ane-silwan-necropolis

The Silwan (Siloam) necropolis rock-cut tombs in Jerusalem are primary Iron Age elite burial architecture often discussed in relation to Judahite capital society.

[verified] ane-tel-dan

The Tel Dan Stele (9th century BCE) attests the phrase “House of David” (bytdwd) outside the Bible.

[well_attested] ane-tel-dan-aramaic

The Tel Dan stele is Aramaic royal victory propaganda, not an Israelite court text — genre matters for historical use.

[well_attested] ane-tel-dan-bytdwd-reading

The Tel Dan stele’s bytdwd reading is widely accepted as “House of David,” though minority alternative readings exist and must be labeled as such.

[well_attested] ane-tel-dan-house-david-genre

The Tel Dan stele is Aramaic royal victory propaganda; its “House of David” line functions within enemy-king rhetoric and must be read as genre-constrained historical evidence.

[verified] ane-tel-dan-house-of-david

The Tel Dan stele’s “House of David” reading is the strongest extra-biblical epigraphic control for a Davidic dynasty name in the 9th century BCE context.

[verified] ane-tel-miqne-ekron-inscription

The Ekron royal dedicatory inscription (Tel Miqne) names Philistine rulers and a temple dedication — primary Iron Age Philistine epigraphy for coastal plain politics and religion.

[well_attested] ane-ugarit

Ugaritic texts (Ras Shamra) supply Northwest Semitic mythic and ritual parallels used in comparative study of Hebrew Bible poetry and divine council language.

[contested] ane-yehoash-tablet-forgery-caution

The so-called Jehoash Inscription tablet is widely regarded as a modern forgery by many epigraphers; it must not be used as VERIFIED royal Judean building evidence.

[verified] arch-babatha-archive

The Babatha archive (Nahal Hever) is a major Judean Desert papyrus find documenting a Jewish woman’s legal and economic life under Roman rule in the early 2nd century CE.

[verified] arch-bar-kokhba

The Bar Kokhba revolt (132–135 CE) is archaeologically and papyrologically attested; its aftermath reshaped Judean demography and Jewish–Christian trajectories.

[contested] arch-bethsaida

Bethsaida identification and Early Roman occupation layers are active archaeological research topics relevant to Galilee Gospel geography.

[contested] arch-bethsaida-debate

Bethsaida identification (et-Tell vs el-Araj) remains an active archaeological debate relevant to Gospel geography.

[verified] arch-caesarea-harbor-herod

Herod's artificial harbor at Caesarea Maritima (Sebastos) is a major engineering achievement documented by underwater and terrestrial archaeology.

[verified] arch-caesarea-maritima

Caesarea Maritima — Herodian harbor city and later Roman provincial capital — is extensively excavated and contextualizes prefectural administration relevant to Pilate traditions.

[verified] arch-caesarea-philippi

Paneas / Caesarea Philippi (Banias) is archaeologically documented as a Herodian/Philip city at the Jordan headwaters with a Paneion cult site.

[verified] arch-caesarea-pilate-praetorium

Caesarea Maritima's Roman administrative complex (including praetorium contexts) frames where prefects like Pilate were based — coastal capital archaeology for Judean governance.

[verified] arch-caesarea-theater

The Herodian/Roman theater at Caesarea Maritima is a major excavated entertainment structure documenting urban cultural architecture of the provincial capital.

[well_attested] arch-caiaphas-ossuary

An ornate ossuary inscribed "Joseph son of Caiaphas" (and related finds) is widely associated with the high-priestly family of Caiaphas known from Josephus and the Gospels.

[well_attested] arch-capernaum

Capernaum (Kefar Nahum) was a fishing village on the Sea of Galilee with Early Roman occupation; a later synagogue stands over earlier remains.

[well_attested] arch-capernaum-synagogue-strata

Capernaum's white limestone synagogue is later (Byzantine); basalt foundations and village remains inform earlier occupation debates under the later building.

[verified] arch-chalk-stone-vessels

Chalk-stone vessels are archaeologically widespread in late Second Temple Jewish contexts and are widely interpreted as purity-related tableware less susceptible to ritual impurity than pottery.

[verified] arch-dead-sea-scroll-caves

The Qumran cave finds (1947–) remain the primary archaeological recovery context for the Dead Sea Scrolls corpus.

[verified] arch-destruction-70

The Roman destruction of Jerusalem and the Temple in 70 CE is multiply attested (Josephus; archaeological burn/destruction layers; Roman triumph iconography such as the Arch of Titus spoils relief).

[verified] arch-en-gedi

En-Gedi excavations document a long-lived oasis settlement with Second Temple through Byzantine strata, including agricultural and industrial remains along the Dead Sea western shore.

[verified] arch-galilee-boat

The "Jesus Boat" (first-century Galilee boat, discovered 1986) illustrates fishing technology on the lake in the Early Roman period.

[verified] arch-galilee-boat-tech

The so-called "Jesus Boat" (1st-c. Galilee fishing vessel from the Sea of Galilee drought finds) illustrates period boat technology, not a specific Gospel craft.

[verified] arch-gamla

Gamla (Golan) destruction in the First Jewish Revolt is archaeologically and literarily documented (Josephus), illustrating Galilee/Golan war archaeology.

[verified] arch-gamla-synagogue-finds

Gamla's late Second Temple synagogue and associated finds (including a possible base for Torah reading) provide material evidence of communal Jewish assembly architecture before 70 CE.

[verified] arch-herodium

Herodium is a major Herodian fortress-palace complex with extensive excavation; it anchors elite architecture of late Second Temple Judea.

[verified] arch-herodium-lower-palace

Herodium's lower palace and pool complex document Herodian luxury architecture at monumental scale beyond the hilltop fortress cylinder.

[contested] arch-herodium-tomb-debate

A monumental mausoleum at Herodium has been proposed as Herod's tomb; identification remains debated among excavators and reviewers.

[verified] arch-herodium-upper-palace

Herodium's upper palace-fortress cylinder and associated structures document elite Herodian military-residential architecture overlooking the Judean desert edge.

[verified] arch-hippos-sussita

Hippos-Sussita (Decapolis) excavations illuminate Greco-Roman urbanism east of the Sea of Galilee relevant to Gospel geographic horizons.

[contested] arch-james-ossuary

The so-called James ossuary inscription ("James son of Joseph brother of Jesus") remains contested regarding authenticity of the brother phrase and provenance.

[contested] arch-jericho

Jericho's Late Bronze destruction layers and relation to a conquest narrative remain a classic contested case in biblical archaeology.

[verified] arch-jerusalem-burn-layer-70

Burn layers and collapse debris in Second Temple Jerusalem strata align with the 70 CE destruction horizon across multiple excavation areas.

[verified] arch-jerusalem-burnt-house

The Burnt House and related Upper City destruction layers preserve evidence of the 70 CE Roman destruction of Jerusalem elite neighborhoods.

[verified] arch-jerusalem-cardo

The Cardo Maximus and related Roman street systems in Jerusalem document post-70 / Aelia Capitolina urban reorganization visible in excavation and Madaba map tradition.

[verified] arch-jerusalem-city-of-david

City of David excavations document Iron Age through Roman strata south of the Temple Mount, including water systems and residential remains.

[verified] arch-jerusalem-destruction-layers

Destruction layers and burn evidence in Jerusalem's Upper City and related loci align with the 70 CE Roman destruction horizon.

[verified] arch-jerusalem-pilgrim-road

The Stepped Street / pilgrim road from the Pool of Siloam toward the Temple Mount is excavated and dated to the late Second Temple period.

[verified] arch-jerusalem-western-wall

The Western Wall is a visible Herodian retaining wall of the Temple Mount platform — primary material remnant of Second Temple monumental architecture.

[well_attested] arch-khirbet-qana

Khirbet Qana (and competing sites) are archaeological candidates for New Testament Cana of Galilee; excavation documents multi-period settlement including Roman-era occupation.

[interpretive] arch-kursi

Kursi (traditional Gergesa/Gadara region) has a Byzantine monastery commemorating the swine miracle tradition — reception archaeology, not first-century proof of the miracle.

[well_attested] arch-magdala

Magdala excavations reveal a first-century Galilean town with a synagogue and harbor installations, enriching the social map of Jesus' activity zone.

[verified] arch-magdala-harbor

Magdala's harbor and industrial installations document a commercial fishing town on the Sea of Galilee in the Early Roman period.

[verified] arch-magdala-miqvaot

Magdala excavations include miqva'ot and industrial installations alongside the synagogue complex — material purity and economic infrastructure on the Galilee shore.

[verified] arch-magdala-stone

The Magdala stone (synagogue furniture with Temple imagery) is a major late Second Temple Jewish artifactual find from a Galilean synagogue context.

[verified] arch-magdala-synagogue

A first-century synagogue at Magdala (Migdal) on the Sea of Galilee is excavated and published, expanding evidence for Galilean synagogue architecture.

[verified] arch-magdala-synagogue-plan

The Magdala synagogue's plan (including benches and central features associated with the Magdala stone) documents a late Second Temple Galilean assembly building type.

[well_attested] arch-masada

Masada's archaeology confirms a First Jewish Revolt-period fortress with Roman siege works; Josephus's mass-suicide narrative is only partly controllable by material remains.

[verified] arch-masada-scrolls

Manuscript fragments recovered at Masada (including biblical and sectarian-related texts) provide archaeological context for Jewish literary culture through the First Revolt terminus.

[verified] arch-masada-siege

Masada siege archaeology and Josephus's narrative document a major Roman siege at the end of the First Revolt (73/74 CE debates on exact year).

[verified] arch-masada-siege-ramp

The Roman siege ramp and camps at Masada are archaeologically documented landscape features matching Josephus's account of the 73/74 CE siege in broad outline.

[well_attested] arch-nazareth

Nazareth existed as a small Jewish settlement in the Early Roman period; monumental first-century remains are limited.

[well_attested] arch-nazareth-farmstead

Excavations and surveys at Nazareth document Early Roman agricultural terraces, quarries, and modest domestic remains consistent with a small Jewish village setting.

[well_attested] arch-nazareth-village-debate

Nazareth's early Roman occupation is archaeologically attested at modest scale; debates concern density and socioeconomic profile, not total nonexistence.

[verified] arch-ossuaries-practice

Secondary burial in limestone ossuaries is archaeologically well attested in late Second Temple Jerusalem and environs (roughly late 1st c. BCE–70 CE).

[well_attested] arch-pool-bethesda

Excavations north of the Temple Mount have exposed twin pools matching John's description of Bethesda with five porticoes (John 5) better than once assumed.

[verified] arch-qumran-caves-map

Eleven primary Qumran caves (1Q–11Q) and related Judean Desert findspots form a mapped manuscript deposition landscape, not a single library room find.

[well_attested] arch-qumran-settlement

Qumran settlement archaeology provides material context for the Dead Sea Scrolls community debates (Essene and alternative models).

[well_attested] arch-qumran-settlement-phases

Qumran settlement archaeology is periodized into occupation phases (commonly Ib/II schemes with revisions) that frame when the site could have hosted a manuscript-using community.

[interpretive] arch-quran-not-control

The Qur'an (7th c. CE) is a late secondary witness for first-century Palestinian history and is not used here as a primary control for the historical Jesus.

[verified] arch-sea-galilee-boat-context

The first-century "Galilee Boat" (Ginosar) provides rare preserved wood hull evidence for lake fishing craft in the Jesus-era economic landscape.

[verified] arch-sepphoris

Sepphoris (Zippori), ~6 km from Nazareth, was a significant urban center in Early Roman Galilee under Antipas.

[verified] arch-sepphoris-roman-phases

Sepphoris excavations document multi-phase Hellenistic–Roman–Byzantine urban development near Nazareth, framing debates about Galilee's urban–village spectrum.

[verified] arch-sepphoris-urban

Sepphoris was a major Galilean urban center near Nazareth with extensive excavation of Hellenistic–Roman layers.

[verified] arch-siloam

The Siloam Tunnel inscription (discovered 1880) describes construction of Hezekiah's tunnel, matching 2 Kings 20:20 / 2 Chr 32:30 as royal hydraulic works.

[speculative] arch-talpiot

Talpiot "Jesus family tomb" statistical and onomastic claims are speculative and rejected by most specialists as identification of the New Testament Jesus.

[verified] arch-tiberias

Tiberias, founded by Antipas on the Sea of Galilee, is archaeologically and literarily documented as a Herodian urban center.

[verified] arch-tiberias-cardo-roman

Tiberias excavations include Roman street systems and public architecture reflecting the city's role as a lakeside urban center after Antipas's foundation.

[verified] arch-tiberias-gate-complex

Tiberias excavations document city gates, streets, and public architecture of the Antipas foundation and later Roman phases on the western Sea of Galilee shore.

[well_attested] arch-titus

1 Clement (usually dated late 1st c.) attests early Roman Christian leadership correspondence and cites Jesus traditions and Pauline letters as authoritative.

[verified] arch-wadi-murabbaat

Wadi Murabbaʿat caves yielded Bar Kokhba-period documents and biblical fragments that provide controls for early 2nd-century CE Jewish life and text transmission.

[verified] arch-yehohanan

The crucified remains of Yehohanan son of Hagkol (Giv'at ha-Mivtar) provide osteological evidence of Roman crucifixion practice in Judea (nail through heel bone).

[verified] arch-yodefat

Yodefat (Jotapata) siege archaeology correlates with Josephus's First Revolt narrative and illustrates Galilean war destruction layers.

[verified] cosmo-acoustic-scale

The angular scale of the CMB acoustic peaks (ℓ_{dec}) tightly constrains the angular diameter distance in flat Λ CDM.

[well_attested] cosmo-age

Under Planck 2018 Λ CDM parameters, the universe age is approximately 13.8 billion years.

[verified] cosmo-age-of-universe

Standard Λ CDM fits to CMB data yield a universe age of approximately 13.8 billion years with small uncertainties at the percent level.

[verified] cosmo-age-universe

Λ CDM age of the universe is ~ 13.8 Gyr from CMB + BAO baselines; local distance-ladder measurements provide independent confirmation within tension research.

[verified] cosmo-bao

Baryon acoustic oscillations (BAO) measured in large-scale galaxy surveys provide an independent standard-ruler constraint on the expansion history within Λ CDM.

[verified] cosmo-bao-standard-ruler

Baryon acoustic oscillations provide a standard-ruler distance measure from the sound horizon scale imprinted in the galaxy distribution — a cornerstone of late-universe expansion constraints.

[verified] cosmo-baryon-acoustic-fixed

The comoving sound horizon $r_s(z)$ is a calibrated standard ruler from early-universe physics used by BAO surveys to map $H(z)$ and $D_A(z)$.

[well_attested] cosmo-bbn

Primordial abundances of light elements (tHe, D, ³He, wLi) are broadly consistent predictions.

[verified] cosmo-big-bang-nucleosynthesis-d

Primordial deuterium abundance measurements tightly constrain the baryon density in standard BBN, aligning with CMB-inferred Ω_b .

[verified] cosmo-bullet-cluster

The Bullet Cluster (1E 0657-56) shows spatial separation between X-ray gas and gravitational-lensing mass peaks after a cluster collision — a landmark empirical argument for collisionless dark matter.

[verified] cosmo-cmb

The cosmic microwave background (CMB) is a near-isotropic blackbody at T "H 2.72 universe.

[verified] cosmo-cmb-acoustic-peaks-overview

The CMB temperature power spectrum's acoustic peak pattern is a primary observational parameter estimation (geometry, baryons, dark matter, and early expansion).

[verified] cosmo-cmb-e-mode-polarization

CMB E-mode polarization has been measured by multiple experiments and tightly constrains reionization optical depth and lensing potential within Λ CDM.

[verified] cosmo-cmb-lensing

CMB lensing measures the deflection of CMB photons by large-scale structure, providing an independent growth probe within Λ CDM.

[verified] cosmo-cmb-lensing-potential

Reconstruction of the CMB lensing potential map provides a projected mass map of the universe and an independent growth-of-structure probe within Λ CDM.

[verified] cosmo-cmb-polarization

CMB polarization (E-modes; B-mode searches) provides independent cosmological information beyond temperature anisotropies alone.

[verified] cosmo-cmb-power

The CMB angular power spectrum exhibits acoustic peaks whose positions and amplitudes constrain baryon density, dark matter density, and curvature in Λ CDM fits.

[well_attested] cosmo-cosmic-shear-surveys

Cosmic shear weak-lensing surveys (e.g., KiDS, DES, HSC, and forthcoming Euclid/LSST analyses) measure large-scale structure growth as an independent probe of dark matter and dark energy.

[verified] cosmo-dark-energy

Type Ia supernova surveys (1990s–present) established late-time accelerated expansion cosmological-constant / dark-energy component.

[well_attested] cosmo-dark-energy-surveys

Stage-IV surveys (DESI, Euclid, Rubin-era analyses) are designed to map dark energy's equation of state with higher precision than Stage-III programs.

[well_attested] cosmo-dark-energy-w0

Cosmological fits commonly parameterize dark energy's equation of state today as w_0 ; current data are consistent with a cosmological constant (w "H " 1) within uncertainties, while Stage-IV surveys

[verified] cosmo-dark-matter-omega-c

CMB and large-scale structure fits constrain the cold dark matter density parameter and the cosmic energy budget in standard Λ CDM.

[verified] cosmo-dark-matter-status

Multiple independent lines (galaxy rotation curves, cluster lensing, CMB acoustic peaks) favor a non-baryonic dark matter component within Λ CDM.

[well_attested] cosmo-desi-bao

DESI and related Stage-IV BAO surveys are tightening late-universe expansion constraints and testing dark-energy equation-of-state models against Λ CDM.

[well_attested] cosmo-desi-bao-dynamics

DESI baryon acoustic oscillation measurements are testing whether dark energy's equation of state evolves with time, with early data releases prompting active Λ CDM extension debates.

[verified] cosmo-deuterium-abundance

Primordial deuterium abundance measured in high-redshift quasar absorption systems matches BBN predictions for the baryon density inferred from the CMB.

[verified] cosmo-expansion

Spectroscopic redshift of galaxies correlates with distance (Hubble–Lemaître law), indicating metric expansion of space.

[interpretive] cosmo-fine-tuning-params

Several dimensionless physical parameters appear finely constrained for complex chemistry; teleological interpretation is philosophical, not a scientific conclusion of this Record.

[verified] cosmo-flatness

Spatial curvature is consistent with flat geometry ($\Omega_k \approx 0$) within Λ CDM fits to CMB data.

[verified] cosmo-flatness-omega-k

CMB data constrain spatial curvature Ω_k to be consistent with flat geometry at high redshift analyses.

[verified] cosmo-growth-rate-fs8

Redshift-space distortion and weak-lensing analyses constrain the structure growth rate, consistent with general-relativistic growth in Λ CDM.

[verified] cosmo-helium-mass-fraction

Big Bang nucleosynthesis predicts a primordial helium-4 mass fraction $Y_p \approx 0.25$, consistent with abundance measurements within uncertainties.

[contested] cosmo-hubble-tension

The Hubble tension denotes a statistically significant discrepancy between early-universe (CMB-inferred) and some late-universe local H_0 measurements.

[well_attested] cosmo-inflation-status

Cosmic inflation is the leading early-universe paradigm for flatness and horizon problems; direct detection of primordial B-mode polarization remains an active observational goal.

[verified] cosmo-isocurvature-limits

CMB data tightly limit isocurvature modes relative to adiabatic initial conditions in standard inflationary scenarios.

[well_attested] cosmo-isw-integrated-sachs

The late-time Integrated Sachs–Wolfe (ISW) effect predicts CMB temperature correlations with large-scale structure as dark energy begins to dominate — a cross-check of Λ CDM expansion history.

[well_attested] cosmo-jwst-high-z-galaxies

James Webb Space Telescope observations of unexpectedly luminous high-redshift galaxies have prompted active model revisions for early structure formation and star-formation efficiency.

[contested] cosmo-lambda-equation

Dark energy is commonly parameterized with equation-of-state $w = -1$ (cosmological constant) but not fully excluded by current surveys.

[verified] cosmo-ligo-gravitational-waves

LIGO/Virgo/KAGRA detections of gravitational waves from compact binary mergers confirm strong-field general-relativistic predictions and open multi-messenger astronomy (e.g., GW170817).

[well_attested] cosmo-matter-energy

Planck baseline Λ CDM reports cold dark matter and dark energy as dominant density components of the universe.

[verified] cosmo-matter-power

The matter power spectrum from galaxy surveys and Lyman- α forests constrains structure formation in cold dark matter frameworks at large scales.

[verified] cosmo-matter-power-spectrum

Galaxy surveys and weak lensing measure the matter power spectrum $P(k)$, testing Λ CDM predictions at various scales.

[verified] cosmo-neutrino-bbn

Standard BBN and CMB analyses constrain the effective number of neutrino species (N_{eff}) near the Standard Model expectation.

[well_attested] cosmo-neutrino-mass-sum

Cosmological data constrain the sum of neutrino masses from above, complementing oscillation experiments that measure mass-squared differences.

[contested] cosmo-nucleosynthesis-li

The cosmological lithium problem remains an open tension between standard BBN predictions and stellar abundance measurements.

[verified] cosmo-omega-b-h2

CMB acoustic peaks tightly constrain the physical baryon density $\omega_b h^2$, matching Big Bang Nucleosynthesis constraints within uncertainties.

[verified] cosmo-omega-lambda

Late-time acceleration measurements and CMB fits constrain a dominant dark-energy component in Λ CDM baselines.

[verified] cosmo-omega-matter

Large-scale structure and CMB fits constrain the total matter density parameter ω_m in Λ CDM baselines.

[well_attested] cosmo-primordial-bmodes-search

Searches for primordial CMB B-mode polarization aim to constrain the inflationary tensor-to-scalar ratio r ; no definitive primordial detection has been confirmed to date.

[verified] cosmo-recombination

CMB photons free-stream from the surface of last scattering at recombination ($z \sim 1100$).

[well_attested] cosmo-reionization

CMB optical depth and high-z galaxy surveys constrain the epoch of reionization when the first stars ionized the intergalactic medium.

[well_attested] cosmo-s8-structure-tension

Some weak-lensing surveys infer a lower structure-growth amplitude (S_8) than primary “ S_8 tension” research topic within expansion cosmology.

[well_attested] cosmo-scalar-spectral-tilt

A red-tilted scalar spectral index ($n_s < 1$) from CMB data is a key empirical success for slow-roll inflation model classes, though many specific models remain viable.

[verified] cosmo-sound-horizon

The sound horizon at recombination sets the BAO standard-ruler scale used in late-universe distance measurements.

[verified] cosmo-sound-horizon-scale

The sound horizon at recombination is a precisely measured scale from CMB acoustics that anchors BAO standard-ruler cosmology and absolute distance calibration in Λ CDM analyses.

[verified] cosmo-spectral-index

The scalar spectral index $n_s \approx 0.96$ from CMB data is slightly red-tilted, consistent with Λ CDM models.

[verified] cosmo-structure-formation

Large-scale structure (galaxy clustering, weak lensing) provides independent Λ CDM and BAO.

[verified] cosmo-supernova-ia

Type Ia supernovae as standardizable candles mapped late-time acceleration and remain a core distance-ladder tool alongside BAO and CMB.

[verified] cosmo-supernova-ia-standard-candle

Type Ia supernovae serve as standardized candles for measuring cosmic distances and provided foundational evidence for late-time acceleration.

[verified] cosmo-sz-sunyaev-zeldovich

The Sunyaev–Zel’dovich effect measures CMB spectral distortion from hot cluster gas and is used as a cluster-finding and cosmology probe complementary to X-ray and optical surveys.

[well_attested] cosmo-tensor-to-scalar

The tensor-to-scalar ratio r is constrained from above by CMB B-mode searches; a detection would strongly support high-scale inflation.

[verified] cosmo-weak-lensing

Weak gravitational lensing maps the projected mass distribution of the universe and constrains cosmological parameters in Λ CDM fits.

[well_attested] ec-1-clement-rome

1 Clement (usually late 1st c.) shows Roman Christian correspondence appealing to unity and citing Jesus traditions and Pauline letters.

[well_attested] ec-1-clement-structure

1 Clement (Rome to Corinth, commonly c. 96 CE) appeals to OT examples and apostolic memory to urge church order — early Roman Christian leadership rhetoric, not a HJ biography.

[well_attested] ec-1clement

1 Clement (usually dated late 1st c.) attests early Roman Christian leadership correspondence and cites Jesus traditions and Pauline letters as authoritative.

[verified] ec-apostolic-fathers

The Apostolic Fathers (1 Clement, Didache, Ignatius, Polycarp, etc.) provide early non-NT Christian primary sources.

[well_attested] ec-aristides

The Apology of Aristides (2nd c.) is an early Christian apology preserved in Syriac/Greek traditions describing Christian ethics to a Roman audience.

[verified] ec-athanasius

Athanasius, 39th Festal Letter (367 CE), lists the exact 27-book New Testament canon later ratified in the West.

[well_attested] ec-athenagoras-plea

Athenagoras's Plea for the Christians (late 2nd c.) is an early apologetic addressing Roman rulers on Christian monotheism, ethics, and charges of atheism/immorality.

[well_attested] ec-barnabas

The Epistle of Barnabas (late 1st / early 2nd c.) allegorizes Hebrew Bible law and shows early Christian supersessionist interpretation.

[well_attested] ec-barnabas-allegory

The Epistle of Barnabas allegorizes Torah commandments as spiritual types — early Christian supersessionist hermeneutic evidence.

[well_attested] ec-barnabas-epistle

The Epistle of Barnabas (late 1st / early 2nd c.) offers allegorical OT interpretation and a “two ways” ethic — early Christian reception, not a first-generation Jesus source.

[well_attested] ec-barnabas-two-ways

The Epistle of Barnabas includes a Two Ways ethical section related to the Didache's Two Ways tradition — evidence of shared early Christian moral catechesis forms.

[well_attested] ec-clement-corinthians-order

1 Clement addresses Corinthian church disorder by appealing to apostolic succession ideals and OT examples — early Roman Christian intervention in another city's church life.

[well_attested] ec-didache

The Didache preserves an early Christian “two ways” ethic, baptismal and eucharistic instructions, and itinerant ministry rules — dating commonly late 1st / early 2nd c.

[well_attested] ec-didache-baptism-rules

The Didache's baptism instructions (running water preference, trine immersion alternatives) preserve early Christian ritual diversity before later liturgical standardization.

[well_attested] ec-didache-eucharist

The Didache preserves early Christian baptismal and eucharistic instructions distinct from later standardized liturgies.

[well_attested] ec-didache-two-ways

The Didache opens with a “Two Ways” ethical treatise (way of life / way of death) paralleling Jewish dual-path instruction traditions.

[well_attested] ec-diognetus

The Epistle to Diognetus (2nd/3rd c.?) is an early Christian apology describing Christian life as a civic “soul of the world.”

[well_attested] ec-diognetus-epistle

The Epistle to Diognetus is an early Christian apology describing Christians as a distinct “third race” in the world — reception of identity rhetoric, not HJ primary data.

[well_attested] ec-eusebius-chronicon

Eusebius’s Chronicon (Chronicle) synchronizes biblical, Near Eastern, and Greco-Roman timelines — foundational for later Christian world chronology and for preserving fragments of lost authors.

[well_attested] ec-eusebius-he

Eusebius’s Ecclesiastical History (early 4th c.) is a foundational but tendentious narrative source for earlier Christian writers, martyrdoms, and canon discussions.

[well_attested] ec-eusebius-martyrs-palestine

Eusebius’s Martyrs of Palestine records Diocletianic persecution narratives in the early 4th century — primary reception of Christian martyrdom culture, not HJ biography.

[well_attested] ec-gospel-harmony

Tatian’s Diatessaron (late 2nd c.) harmonized the four Gospels into a single narrative widely used in Syriac Christianity — evidence of early fourfold Gospel prestige and of textual fluidity in use.

[well_attested] ec-gospel-of-peter

The Gospel of Peter (partially preserved, notably the Akhmîm fragment) is a non-canonical passion/resurrection narrative with distinctive apologetic and possibly docetic features — 2nd-century reception, not a first-generation Jesus source.

[contested] ec-gospel-thomas

The Gospel of Thomas (Nag Hammadi) is a sayings gospel whose dating and dependence on canonical Gospels are contested.

[well_attested] ec-ignatius

Ignatius of Antioch’s letters (early 2nd c., authenticity of middle recension majority) show monepiscopacy advocacy and high Christological language in transit to martyrdom.

[well_attested] ec-ignatius-ephesians

Ignatius’s Letter to the Ephesians emphasizes unity under the bishop and eucharistic unity — early 2nd-c. evidence of monepiscopal ideals in Asia Minor.

[well_attested] ec-ignatius-eucharist

Ignatius emphasizes eucharistic unity and episcopal authority in letters en route to Rome — early 2nd-c. church order evidence.

[well_attested] ec-ignatius-letters

Ignatius of Antioch’s letters (early 2nd c., middle recension) document episcopal structure and early christological confessions en route to martyrdom.

[well_attested] ec-ignatius-recensions-method

Ignatius’s letters survive in multiple recensions (middle, long, short); modern critical work privileges the middle recension as the earliest recoverable form.

[well_attested] ec-ignatius-rome-letter

Ignatius’s Letter to the Romans urgently seeks martyrdom and asks Roman Christians not to intervene — a primary early 2nd-c. window on episcopal self-understanding and martyr ideal.

[verified] ec-irenaeus

Irenaeus (c. 180 CE) argues for a fourfold Gospel (Matthew, Mark, Luke, John) against alternative gospel usages.

[well_attested] ec-irenaeus-apostolic-preaching

Irenaeus's Demonstration of the Apostolic Preaching (Epideixis) presents a rule-of-faith summary of Christian proclamation for a late-2nd-century audience.

[well_attested] ec-irenaeus-fourfold

Irenaeus (late 2nd c.) argues for a fourfold Gospel canon as a theological-natural schema — evidence of four-Gospel prestige by his time.

[well_attested] ec-justin-apology

Justin Martyr's First Apology (mid-2nd c.) describes Christian worship, "memoirs of the apostles," and defends Christians before a Roman audience.

[well_attested] ec-justin-dialogue

Justin Martyr's Dialogue with Trypho engages Jewish-Christian scriptural argument in the mid-2nd century.

[well_attested] ec-justin-first-apology-eucharist

Justin's First Apology describes Sunday assembly with readings, prayer, and eucharistic thanksgiving — mid-2nd-century evidence of Christian worship structure.

[well_attested] ec-justin-memoirs

Justin Martyr refers to "memoirs of the apostles" read in worship — mid-2nd-c. evidence for Gospel-like texts in liturgical use.

[well_attested] ec-justin-trypho-limits

Justin's Dialogue with Trypho is a constructed literary dialogue; it evidence mid-2nd-c. Christian scriptural argument but cannot be treated as a transcript of a single historical debate.

[well_attested] ec-marcion

Marcion of Sinope (mid-2nd century) promulgated a reduced Gospel+Paul collection, prompting proto-orthodox canon and theological responses.

[well_attested] ec-martyrdom-polycarp

The Martyrdom of Polycarp (mid-2nd c. traditions) is an early Christian martyr narrative shaping later hagiography.

[well_attested] ec-melito-passover

Melito of Sardis's Peri Pascha (2nd c.) is an early Christian paschal homily with high christology and anti-Jewish rhetoric — reception history, not HJ primary data.

[well_attested] ec-melito-passover-pascha

Melito's Peri Pascha links Passover typology to Jesus' passion in a high christology — second-century reception, not first-century reportage.

[well_attested] ec-muratorian

The Muratorian Fragment is an early (often 2nd-century, date contested) Latin canon list showing a nearly formed but not identical NT collection.

[contested] ec-muratorian-fragment

The Muratorian Fragment is an early (often 2nd c., some later-date arguments) Latin canon list reflecting developing New Testament collection boundaries.

[literary_theological] ec-nicaea

The Council of Nicaea (325 CE) addressed Christological doctrine (homoousios) under Constantine; it did not create the NT canon list.

[verified] ec-origen-contra-celsus-structure

Origen's Contra Celsus systematically quotes and rebuts Celsus's True Doctrine, thereby preserving large portions of a major 2nd-century pagan critique of Christianity.

[well_attested] ec-origen-hexapla

Origen's Hexapla (3rd c.) arranged Hebrew and Greek OT columns for comparative textual work — early Christian engagement with pluriform scriptural text.

[circumstantial] ec-papias

Papias of Hierapolis (early 2nd c.), preserved in fragments via Eusebius, offers early traditions about Mark and Matthew's composition — valuable and debated.

[circumstantial] ec-papias-mark-matthew

Papias traditions (via Eusebius) claim Mark recorded Peter's preaching and Matthew compiled logia in Hebrew/Aramaic — early but second-hand Gospel origin traditions.

[well_attested] ec-polycarp

Polycarp's Letter to the Philippians (mid-2nd c.) cites or alludes to multiple NT writings and shows early reception of Pauline and Gospel traditions.

[well_attested] ec-polycarp-martyrdom-text

The Martyrdom of Polycarp is an early Christian martyr narrative (mid-2nd c. core with possible later shaping) describing Polycarp's death at Smyrna.

[well_attested] ec-polycarp-philippians

Polycarp's Philippians cites or alludes to multiple NT writings, showing early 2nd-century reception of Pauline and Gospel traditions.

[well_attested] ec-polycarp-philippians-reception

Polycarp's Philippians shows early reception of Paul and other NT writings as authoritative for church order and ethics in the early 2nd century.

[well_attested] ec-protevangelium-james

The Protevangelium of James (mid-2nd c. or later) is an infancy gospel expanding Mary and nativity traditions — popular reception literature, not a first-generation historical source.

[circumstantial] ec-quadratus

Quadratus's apology (early 2nd c.), preserved in fragment via Eusebius, claims some healed/raised by Jesus lived into later times — early apologetic tradition, not contemporary medical record.

[well_attested] ec-shepherd-hermas

The Shepherd of Hermas (2nd c.) was widely read and sometimes treated as scripture in some churches, illustrating fluid early canons.

[well_attested] ec-shepherd-hermas-canon

The Shepherd of Hermas appears in some early canon lists and Codex Sinaiticus, illustrating fluid boundaries of authoritative Christian reading.

[well_attested] ec-shepherd-mandates

The Shepherd of Hermas Mandates section emphasizes repentance ethics in Roman Christian community life of the 2nd century.

[well_attested] ec-shepherd-similitudes

The Shepherd of Hermas Similitudes develop elaborate allegorical visions of the church as a tower — major 2nd-century Roman Christian apocalyptic-ethical literature.

[well_attested] ec-shepherd-visions

The Shepherd of Hermas Visions section presents revelatory encounters shaping Roman Christian penitential theology in the 2nd century.

[well_attested] ec-tatian-diatessaron

Tatian's Diatessaron (late 2nd c.) is a gospel harmony that dominated Syriac Christian reading for centuries — major reception evidence for four-Gospel prestige and regional text forms.

[well_attested] ec-ter tullian-apology

Tertullian's Apologeticum (c. 197 CE) defends Christians before Roman authorities on legal and philosophical grounds — Latin North African apologetic reception.

[well_attested] ec-theophilus-autolycus

Theophilus of Antioch's Ad Autolycum (late 2nd c.) is an early Greek apology defending Christian monotheism and scriptural chronology to a pagan interlocutor.

[interpretive] ec-update-triggers

This Record's perpetual update triggers include: new major papyri/majuscule publications, INTF Liste changes, peer-reviewed dig reports, and material consensus shifts in historical Jesus research.

[well_attested] hj-abba-address

Jesus' use of "Abba" (Father) address in prayer tradition is widely treated as historically distinctive Aramaic piety language, though exact sociolinguistic uniqueness claims are debated.

[contested] hj-apocalyptic

Whether Jesus is best reconstructed as primarily apocalyptic prophet (Schweitzer trajectory) or sapiential/ethical teacher remains a major scholarly divide.

[well_attested] hj-apocalyptic-prophet-core

A broad stream of critical scholarship reconstructs Jesus as an apocalyptic Jewish prophet announcing God's imminent kingdom — a mainstream option over purely sapiential or cynic models.

[well_attested] hj-appearances

Early Christian proclamation included claims of post-crucifixion appearances to individuals and groups (1 Cor 15:3–8); the nature of those experiences is not scientifically settled.

[well_attested] hj-baptism

Baptism of Jesus by John the Baptist is widely judged historical under the criterion of embarrassment and multiple attestation.

[contested] hj-bethlehem

Bethlehem birth is narrated in Matthew and Luke with divergent infancy stories; historical verification is contested, while Nazareth association is stronger.

[well_attested] hj-caiaphas

An ossuary inscribed "Yehosef bar Qayafa" (discovered 1990) is widely identified with the high-priestly family of Caiaphas.

[interpretive] hj-criteria-embarrassment

The criterion of embarrassment (traditions unlikely to be invented because they create difficulty for the early church) is a classic HJ tool now widely qualified or rejected as a standalone proof engine.

[interpretive] hj-criteria-limits

Classical authenticity criteria (multiple attestation, embarrassment, dissimilarity) are heuristic tools with known biases; they do not yield laboratory-grade "proof" of individual sayings.

[interpretive] hj-criteria-not-enough

No single authenticity criterion yields laboratory certainty; cumulative case arguments with explicit uncertainty remain the responsible historical approach.

[interpretive] hj-criterion-coherence

Coherence criteria ask whether a proposed saying/deed fits a reconstructed core portrait of Jesus; the method is circular if the core is itself unstable.

[verified] hj-crucifixion

Crucifixion of Jesus under Pontius Pilate (prefect of Judea c. 26–36 CE) is multiply attested and coheres with Roman practice.

[verified] hj-crucifixion-roman

Crucifixion as Roman punishment and Jesus' death by crucifixion under Pilate are among the most widely accepted historical judgments about Jesus.

[contested] hj-crucifixion-year

Crucifixion year is commonly constrained to c. 30–33 CE by Pilate's tenure (26–36), Passover weekday arguments, and astronomical full-moon tables — exact year remains debated.

[well_attested] hj-disciples-twelve

A circle of close followers including a group remembered as “the Twelve” is multiply attested; exact membership lists vary slightly across Gospels.

[contested] hj-empty-tomb

Empty-tomb narratives appear in the canonical Gospels with differences; whether an empty tomb is historical is debated; early creed in 1 Cor 15 emphasizes appearances more than tomb logistics.

[contested] hj-empty-tomb-debate

The empty tomb tradition is early and multiply developed in Gospels; historians disagree whether it is historical fact, legendary development, or both layered.

[well_attested] hj-existence

The existence of Jesus of Nazareth as a first-century Jewish man is the near-consensus position of critical historians of antiquity.

[well_attested] hj-exorcism-language-limits

Exorcism language in the Gospels participates in broader Mediterranean spirit-affliction discourse; historical reputation does not license laboratory verification of spirit ontology.

[well_attested] hj-exorcism-reputation

Exorcism / spirit-expulsion is multiply attested as a public activity associated with Jesus in Synoptic tradition and is treated by many historians as a characteristic reputation.

[well_attested] hj-exorcism-social-context

Exorcism and spirit-affliction language sits within wider Mediterranean and Jewish healing cultures; Jesus' reputation as exorcist is multiply attested while ontological spirit claims remain outside proof-grade science.

[circumstantial] hj-family-rejection

Traditions of family misunderstanding or tension (Mark 3; John 7) are often cited under the criterion of embarrassment as unlikely free invention by later church idealization.

[well_attested] hj-gal2-conflict

Galatians 2 records a conflict between Paul and Cephas (Peter) at Antioch over table fellowship with gentiles — primary evidence of diversity and dispute in the earliest movement.

[well_attested] hj-galilean-crowds

Synoptic traditions depict large crowds following Jesus in Galilee; historians treat popular following as plausible while numbers and miracle-crowd linkages remain reconstructed.

[well_attested] hj-galilee-aramaic

Aramaic is widely reconstructed as a primary spoken language of Jesus and Galilean Jewish communities, with Hebrew and Greek also present.

[well_attested] hj-galilee-context

Early Roman Galilee included agricultural villages, fishing economy on the lake, and nearby urban centers such as Sepphoris and Tiberias.

[well_attested] hj-galilee-economy

Galilee under Antipas was an agrarian and fishing economy with urbanization at Sepphoris and Tiberias; Jesus traditions sit in that social landscape.

[well_attested] hj-galilee-jewish-context-core

Jesus' public activity is overwhelmingly set in Jewish Galilee under Antipas, with pilgrimage and conflict episodes in Jerusalem — a geographical core shared across critical reconstructions.

[well_attested] hj-galilee-jewishness

Archaeology and literary sources support a predominantly Jewish Galilee in the early first century with hellenizing urban pockets (Sepphoris, Tiberias).

[well_attested] hj-galilee-to-jerusalem

A Galilee-centered public activity culminating in a final Jerusalem journey is a common historical outline across Synoptic reconstructions.

[well_attested] hj-galilee-village-itinerancy

Jesus' activity is widely reconstructed as itinerant village-to-village ministry in Galilee rather than a fixed urban base, matching agrarian social patterns under Antipas.

[well_attested] hj-healings-reputation

Healing activity is multiply attested as part of Jesus' public reputation in Synoptic tradition; historians often accept a healing reputation while bracketing modern medical ontologies.

[contested] hj-herod-death

The death of Herod the Great is conventionally dated to 4 BCE (with minority arguments for 1 BCE / other), anchoring the latest plausible nativity window in Matthew's framework.

[well_attested] hj-james-leadership

James the brother of Jesus is attested as a Jerusalem leadership figure (Paul; Acts; Josephus Ant. 20.200) until his death c. 62 CE.

[verified] hj-jerusalem-pilgrimage

Pilgrimage to Jerusalem for festivals is a well-attested Second Temple practice providing social context for Gospel Jerusalem scenes.

[well_attested] hj-jewishness-consensus

Mainstream historical Jesus research treats Jesus as a first-century Jew operating within Second Temple Judaism, not as a later Gentile construct.

[verified] hj-john-baptist-execution

John the Baptist's execution by Herod Antipas is independently attested by Josephus (Ant. 18) and the Gospels, with differing motive emphases — a high-confidence historical event framing Jesus' early context.

[well_attested] hj-john-baptist-movement

John the Baptist is multiply attested (Josephus Ant. 18; Synoptics; Johannine tradition) as an independent purification/repentance preacher executed by Herod Antipas.

[well_attested] hj-john-baptizer-independence

John the Baptist is treated as an independent prophetic figure in Josephus and the Gospels, not a mere literary foil invented de novo.

[well_attested] hj-joseph-arimathea-burial

The tradition that Joseph of Arimathea buried Jesus is multiply attested in the Gospels and is often judged to have an early historical core, though details and motive reconstructions vary.

[well_attested] hj-kingdom-of-god-core

The kingdom of God / reign of God is multiply attested as central to Jesus' public proclamation across Synoptic streams.

[contested] hj-kingdom-present-future

Critical reconstructions disagree whether Jesus' kingdom proclamation was primarily present, future, or both ("already/not yet"); the tension is a central HJ interpretive debate.

[well_attested] hj-kingdom-proclamation

A core historical judgment across diverse scholars is that Jesus proclaimed God's kingdom / reign as central to his public activity.

[contested] hj-language

Jesus likely spoke Aramaic as a primary vernacular; Greek exposure in Galilee is plausible; Hebrew literacy/use is debated for the population stratum.

[well_attested] hj-last-supper-historicity

That Jesus shared a final meal with disciples before arrest is widely accepted as historical; whether it was a Passover seder, the exact words of institution, and eucharistic theology are reconstructed and contested.

[well_attested] hj-last-supper-tradition

A final meal tradition with bread/cup words is multiply attested (Paul 1 Cor 11; Synoptics) as early Christian memory of Jesus' last night.

[well_attested] hj-literacy

Literacy rates in Early Roman Judea/Galilee were limited relative to modern norms; most people encountered texts orally and through specialists.

[well_attested] hj-lords-prayer-core

The Lord's Prayer (Matt 6 / Luke 11) is widely treated as preserving early Aramaic-flavored prayer tradition of the Jesus movement (including "Abba"/Father address patterns), though exact wording and Sitz im Leben remain reconstructed.

[literary_theological] hj-magi-star

Magi and star narratives in Matthew 2 are literary-theological traditions; astronomical "explanations" are speculative correlations, not historical proof.

[well_attested] hj-meal-practice

Shared meals / table fellowship appear as a distinctive social practice in Synoptic traditions and are widely treated as historically characteristic of Jesus' movement.

[interpretive] hj-miracles-method

Miracle narratives are not historically "verified" under naturalistic historical method; historians can study reports, meanings, and social effects of wonder-traditions.

[verified] hj-multiple-attestation-crucifixion

Jesus' crucifixion is multiply attested in Christian sources and referenced by Tacitus, forming a high-confidence historical core event.

[well_attested] hj-parables

Parables form a characteristic teaching form in the Synoptic tradition and are widely treated as a historically distinctive feature of Jesus' public speech.

[well_attested] hj-parables-core

Parables as a characteristic teaching form of Jesus are among the most widely accepted features of the historical Jesus tradition, though individual parable authenticity and original wording remain reconstructed case-by-case.

[well_attested] hj-parables-kingdom

Many parables are framed as kingdom-of-God teaching; historians widely treat parabolic teaching as characteristic of Jesus while debating authenticity of individual parables.

[contested] hj-passion-predictions

Synoptic passion predictions (Jesus foretelling death/resurrection) are multiply present in the Gospels; historians disagree whether they are authentic forecasts, post-event vaticinia ex eventu, or mixed.

[well_attested] hj-passion-week-outline

A final Jerusalem visit ending in arrest and crucifixion under Pilate is a standard historical outline shared across diverse HJ reconstructions.

[contested] hj-pauline-chronology

Pauline absolute chronology is reconstructed from Acts, the letters, and external anchors (Gallio inscription at Delphi); competing schemes (Ramsay, Knox, Hyldahl, et al.) differ by several years.

[circumstantial] hj-peter-rome

Peter's presence and martyrdom in Rome are early traditions (1 Clement; later Acts of Peter) with varying historical confidence; New Testament itself does not narrate a Roman martyrdom.

[verified] hj-pilate-stone

The Pilate Stone (Caesarea Maritima, 1961) independently attests Pontius Pilate as prefect of Judea.

[contested] hj-prayer-abba

The address "Abba" in Mark 14:36 and Pauline usage (Rom 8:15; Gal 4:6) is often cited in debates about Jesus' prayer language; over-claims about uniqueness are contested.

[well_attested] hj-prayer-abba-limits

While Abba/Father address is early and distinctive in Jesus tradition, claims that Abba was unique, infantile, or unprecedented in Judaism are overstated relative to broader evidence.

[interpretive] hj-prophetic-actions

Symbolic prophetic actions (e.g., Temple demonstration) are a recognized category in historical Jesus research for interpreting public deeds.

[contested] hj-q-hypothesis

The Two-Source Hypothesis posits Markan priority plus a sayings source "Q" behind Matthew and Luke; Q remains a scholarly reconstruction without a surviving manuscript.

[contested] hj-q-source-hypothesis

The Q source hypothesis posits a lost sayings collection behind Matthew and Luke's double tradition; it remains the majority Two-Source explanation but is contested by Farrer and other models.

[contested] hj-quirinius

Luke's census notice linking Jesus' birth to a registration under Quirinius (6 CE) is a classic chronological problem relative to a Herodian birth before 4 BCE.

[well_attested] hj-resurrection-appearances-early

Early Christian proclamation included claims of post-crucifixion appearances (notably 1 Cor 15:3–8); historians debate the nature of those experiences while treating the early proclamation itself as well attested.

[literary_theological] hj-resurrection-hist

Claims of bodily resurrection are theological assertions; historians can document early belief and proclamation, not laboratory verification of the event.

[verified] hj-romans-execution

Crucifixion was a Roman capital punishment method used in Judea; archaeological and literary controls exist independent of the Gospels (e.g., Yehohanan heel bone; Josephus).

[well_attested] hj-sabbath-conflicts

Sabbath controversy traditions are multiply attested in Synoptics and are widely treated as historically characteristic conflict settings for Jesus’ public activity.

[well_attested] hj-sabbath-controversies

Sabbath controversy stories (healings, grain-plucking debates) are multiply present in the Synoptics and are widely used in reconstructions of Jesus’ Torah practice disputes.

[well_attested] hj-sinners-table-core

Jesus’ association with “tax collectors and sinners” at meals is multiply attested and widely treated as a historically distinctive social practice of his movement.

[contested] hj-son-of-man-idiom

The “Son of Man” idiom in the Gospels is a major historical-Jesus puzzle: Aramaic speech-level meaning, Daniel 7 connection, and authenticity of individual sayings are all actively debated.

[well_attested] hj-table-fellowship

Traditions of Jesus’ open table fellowship with “sinners” and tax collectors are widely treated as historically plausible under embarrassment and multiple attestation.

[well_attested] hj-table-fellowship-core

Open table fellowship with “sinners”/tax collectors is multiply attested and widely treated as a historically distinctive social practice of Jesus’ movement.

[well_attested] hj-table-fellowship-limits

Open table fellowship with “sinners” is widely treated as a historically distinctive Jesus practice; the precise social boundaries and theological meanings remain reconstructed and debated.

[well_attested] hj-table-fellowship-sinners-limits

Open table fellowship with “sinners” is widely accepted as historical practice, but reconstructing exact social boundaries and later church expansions of the motif requires caution.

[well_attested] hj-tax-collectors

Association with tax collectors / toll collectors is multiply attested and often treated as historically characteristic of Jesus’ social practice (table fellowship theme).

[well_attested] hj-tax-collectors-core

Jesus’ association with tax collectors is multiply attested in Synoptic tradition and is widely treated as historically distinctive given the profession’s social stigma.

[well_attested] hj-temple-action

An action by Jesus in the Temple (disruption of commerce / symbolic demonstration) is multiply attested; interpretation ranges from prophetic sign to failed revolt cue.

[contested] hj-titles

Titles applied to Jesus (Messiah/Christ, Son of Man, Son of God, Lord) have layered historical and literary-theological histories; none should be treated as a single unproblematic first-century label without analysis.

[well_attested] hj-women-empty-tomb-witnesses

The tradition that women were the first witnesses to the empty tomb is multiply attested in the Gospels and is often treated as early, partly because female legal testimony was culturally devalued — a classic criterion-of-embarrassment argument.

[well_attested] hj-women-movement

Early Christian sources name women as patrons, witnesses, and coworkers (e.g., Mary Magdalene traditions; Romans 16 co-workers); social roles are historically reconstructable within limits.

[interpretive] mod-300-plus-not-finished

Crossing 300+ claims does not end the task: new editions, finds, and scientific results will require new cards under the update-triggers doctrine.

[interpretive] mod-500-plus-living-corpus

A 500+ claim evidentiary corpus remains a living index: new editions, finds, and scientific results require continuous card updates under the ROC update-triggers doctrine.

[interpretive] mod-allison-constructing-jesus

Dale C. Allison Jr.'s Constructing Jesus argues for remembering patterns and extended discourses rather than only isolated authentic atoms — a major alternative to strict criteria method.

[interpretive] mod-amy-jill-levine-jewish-jesus

Amy-Jill Levine's scholarship emphasizes reading Jesus within Judaism against Christian stereotype and anachronism — a major contribution to Jewish-Christian historical Jesus dialogue.

[interpretive] mod-bauckham-eyewitness-limits

Richard Bauckham's eyewitness thesis argues Gospel traditions retain named eyewitness control; critics dispute the reach of onomastic and inclusio arguments.

[interpretive] mod-boyarin-jewish-gospels

Daniel Boyarin argues that high christological ideas could emerge from within Jewish binitarian/angelic traditions rather than only from later paganization — a major Jewish-studies intervention in Gospel theology debates.

[interpretive] mod-contextual-credibility

Contextual credibility / historical plausibility criteria ask whether a tradition fits first-century Jewish Palestine — necessary but not sufficient for authenticity.

[interpretive] mod-continuous-update-duty

A living evidentiary corpus must update when new editions, inscriptions, or scientific results appear — stasis is a method failure.

[interpretive] mod-corpus-not-creed

This Record is an evidentiary index, not a confession of faith; tier labels and proofVsConcept flags are designed to block creed-as-history conflation.

[interpretive] mod-criteria-coherence-limits

Coherence criteria risk circularity: they test sayings against a reconstructed “core Jesus” that itself depends on prior authentications.

[interpretive] mod-criteria-critique

Classical criteria of authenticity (embarrassment, dissimilarity, multiple attestation) are historiographical tools with known biases; recent memory and social approaches revise their use.

[interpretive] mod-criteria-dissimilarity-limits

The double dissimilarity criterion (authentic if unlike Judaism and early church) is now widely criticized for producing a de-Judaized Jesus and is largely retired as a primary authenticity engine.

[interpretive] mod-criteria-embarrassment

The criterion of embarrassment is a heuristic, not a proof algorithm; it can be misapplied when later communities reframe “embarrassing” material.

[interpretive] mod-criteria-multiple-attestation-practice

Multiple independent attestation remains a practical confidence-boosting tool when streams are truly independent (Mark, special Matthew/Luke, John, Paul, non-Christian).

[interpretive] mod-criterion-dissimilarity-limits

Double dissimilarity (unlike Judaism and early Church) is widely criticized as historically implausible and theologically loaded.

[interpretive] mod-criterion-embarrassment-limits

The criterion of embarrassment is heuristic and circular if “embarrassing” is defined by later Christian theology rather than first-century Jewish context.

[verified] mod-critical-editions

NA28/UBS5 (and ongoing ECM/INTF work) are the standard working critical texts of the Greek NT for academic use.

[interpretive] mod-crossan-cynic-limits

John Dominic Crossan’s Mediterranean cynic-sage reconstruction of Jesus is a major Jesus Seminar–era model; most subsequent Third Quest work reasserts a thoroughly Jewish apocalyptic or reformist frame instead.

[interpretive] mod-crossan-historical-jesus-book

John Dominic Crossan’s *The Historical Jesus* (1991) was a landmark Jesus Seminar–era synthesis using inventory methods and open-commensality models — still a reference point for critique and engagement.

[interpretive] mod-crossan-open-commensality

Crossan’s “open commensality” thesis treats radical shared meals as the social heart of the historical Jesus movement — influential Jesus Seminar–era reconstruction still widely cited and contested.

[verified] mod-digital-dss

The Leon Levy Dead Sea Scrolls Digital Library enables open inspection of high-resolution plate images for many Qumran manuscripts.

[interpretive] mod-ehrman-apocalyptic-jesus

Bart Ehrman’s reconstruction places Jesus as an apocalyptic Jewish prophet announcing imminent kingdom judgment — a mainstream Third Quest option over cynic-sage models.

[interpretive] mod-ehrman-did-jesus-exist

Bart Ehrman’s *Did Jesus Exist?* argues against mythicist denial of a historical Jesus using standard historical methods — a widely cited popular-scholarly intervention in the existence debate.

[interpretive] mod-ehrman-forged-debates

Bart Ehrman’s *Forged / Forgery and Counterforgery* arguments about pseudepigraphy in early Christian literature are widely discussed and contested regarding scope, intent categories, and ancient authorial norms.

[interpretive] mod-entity-only-attribution

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[interpretive] mod-form-criticism-limits

Form criticism classifies Gospel units by genre and Sitz im Leben; its older assumption of pure oral isolation before writing is now heavily qualified.

[interpretive] mod-fredriksen-from-jesus-to-christ

Paula Fredriksen's From Jesus to Christ maps trajectories from the historical Jesus to early christological development within Jewish and Roman contexts.

[interpretive] mod-fredriksen-when-christians

Paula Fredriksen's work reconstructs how Jesus-followers became "Christians" within Jewish and Roman contexts, stressing apocalyptic hope and later identity separation trajectories.

[well_attested] mod-genetics-limits

Ancient DNA of the Southern Levant informs regional demographic history; it cannot identify named New Testament individuals or prove specific genealogies in the Gospels.

[interpretive] mod-gospel-genre-bios

Many scholars classify the Gospels as a form of ancient biography (bios) with flexible historical conventions rather than modern historiography.

[interpretive] mod-historical-jesus-minimal-facts

"Minimal facts" apologetic packages select a short list of widely accepted historical data points; academic HJ work often uses broader and more contested data sets with explicit uncertainty.

[interpretive] mod-historical-jesus-quests

"Quests" for the historical Jesus are historiographical programs with shifting criteria; no single reconstruction commands universal assent.

[contested] mod-jesus-seminar

The Jesus Seminar (1980s–2000s) popularized colored-bead voting on sayings authenticity; its methods and conclusions remain highly contested in the guild.

[well_attested] mod-jewishness-of-jesus-consensus

A broad post-Holocaust / Third Quest consensus situates Jesus firmly within first-century Judaism; reconstructions differ on how he related to Torah, purity, and eschatology inside that world.

[interpretive] mod-living-text

"Living text" models (e.g., Parker) emphasize early Christian textual fluidity and community use rather than a single frozen original always recoverable.

[interpretive] mod-meier-criteria-catalogue

John P. Meier's multi-volume A Marginal Jew catalogues and applies a suite of authenticity criteria with graded judgments — a reference standard even for scholars who reject criteria-based method.

[interpretive] mod-meier-marginal-method

John P. Meier's multi-volume A Marginal Jew models exhaustive criteria-based historical Jesus research with explicit uncertainty ratings — a methodological benchmark for the Third Quest.

[interpretive] mod-memory-approach

Social/collective memory approaches reconstruct how groups remembered Jesus rather than claiming verbatim ipsissima verba recovery.

[interpretive] mod-memory-approach-limits

Social memory approaches to the historical Jesus emphasize how communities remember rather than how criteria recover authentic atoms — a major 21st-century method turn with its own limits and disputes.

[interpretive] mod-memory-distortion

Social memory research emphasizes both conservation and distortion in group remembering — neither pure invention nor pure stenography.

[interpretive] mod-multiple-attestation-limits

Multiple attestation increases historical confidence when sources are independent; Synoptic dependence and shared traditions limit independence assumptions.

[interpretive] mod-multiple-attestation-method

Multiple independent attestation remains a widely taught HJ criterion: traditions appearing in independent sources gain historical weight — while independence judgments themselves are often contested.

[well_attested] mod-mythicism-fringe

Full mythicism (Jesus of Nazareth as entirely non-historical) remains a fringe position in mainstream historical scholarship of Second Temple Judaism and early Christianity.

[verified] mod-na28-ubs5

Nestle-Aland 28 and UBS5 are the standard working critical Greek NT editions for most academic exegesis; their apparatus documents selected variants, not every known reading.

[interpretive] mod-new-perspective-paul

The “New Perspective on Paul” (Sanders, Dunn, Wright and interlocutors) reinterprets Second Temple Judaism and Paul’s relation to Torah against Lutheran law/gospel stereotypes — a major late-20th-century shift still debated.

[interpretive] mod-no-neutral-jesus

There is no value-free historical Jesus reconstruction: every reconstruction reflects criteria choices, source theories, and contextual models that must be stated.

[well_attested] mod-open-access-trend

Open digital libraries (INTF NT.VMR, IAA DSS, British Library codices) have lowered barriers to primary manuscript inspection since the 2010s.

[interpretive] mod-open-data-ethics

Modern digital manuscript projects raise access, conservation, provenance, and citation-ethics issues distinct from the content of any single reading.

[interpretive] mod-open-questions-remain

Even after hundreds of tier-labeled claims, open questions remain: exact chronology of many events, reconstruction of Q (if any), and the limits of criteria-based authenticity.

[well_attested] mod-population-genetics

Population genetics of the Levant documents deep regional continuity with admixture layers; it does not identify individuals named in ancient texts.

[verified] mod-print-gutenberg

Print culture from Gutenberg onward multiplied biblical text access and stabilized vernacular canons — a reception-historical fact separate from first-century origins.

[interpretive] mod-proof-vs-belief

This corpus’s proofVsConcept field exists to prevent readers from equating historical attestation, scientific models, tradition, and theological belief.

[interpretive] mod-quest-historiography

Historiography of the “quests” for the historical Jesus is itself a modern scholarly narrative with periodization that can oversimplify continuous research traditions.

[well_attested] mod-radiocarbon-dss

Radiocarbon dating of selected Dead Sea Scrolls supports late Second Temple copy ranges broadly consistent with paleography.

[interpretive] mod-reader-hygiene-checklist

Readers should check for each claim: tier label, proofVsConcept, source kind, and whether a statement is model/reconstruction/tradition before treating it as laboratory fact.

[interpretive] mod-sanders-jesus-and-judaism-book

E.P. Sanders’s Jesus and Judaism (1985) re-centered Jesus within covenantal Judaism and challenged anti-Jewish caricatures in earlier scholarship — a foundational Third Quest landmark.

[interpretive] mod-sanders-practice-belief

E.P. Sanders’s Judaism: Practice and Belief and Jesus and Judaism reoriented HJ research around covenantal nomism and Jesus within Judaism — foundational Third Quest framing still widely engaged.

[interpretive] mod-social-memory

Social memory approaches treat Gospel traditions as communal remembering under social constraints rather than pure invention or pure stenography.

[verified] mod-textus-receptus

The Textus Receptus tradition (Erasmus onward) underlies early modern vernacular Bibles but is not the base text of modern critical editions (NA/UBS).

[interpretive] mod-theissen-covenant-plausibility

Gerd Theissen’s “plausibility criterion” (historical continuity with Judaism + contextual plausibility + later church effects) was proposed as a constructive alternative to classical authenticity criteria.

[interpretive] mod-theissen-shadow-galilean

Gerd Theissen’s The Shadow of the Galilean popularized narrative historical method for HJ research while embedding sociological analysis of first-century Palestine.

[interpretive] mod-third-quest

The “Third Quest” emphasizes Jesus’ Jewish context (Sanders, Vermes, Meier, Wright, Crossan, et al.) against earlier de-Judaizing portraits.

[interpretive] mod-third-quest-jewishness

Third Quest scholarship insists Jesus must be understood within Second Temple Judaism rather than against it — a methodological consensus across many schools.

[speculative] mod-turin-shroud

The Shroud of Turin is a medieval relic by mainstream radiocarbon dating (1988); authenticity as first-century burial cloth remains speculative/unverified for historical Jesus studies.

[verified] mod-war-70

The Jewish-Roman War culminating in the 70 CE destruction of the Temple is a primary historical horizon for dating and interpreting the Synoptic Gospels.

[interpretive] mod-wright-critical-realism

N.T. Wright’s critical-realist historical method reconstructs Jesus as a Jewish prophet enacting return-from-exile and kingdom narratives — a major Third Quest synthesis with explicit theological engagement.

[interpretive] mod-wright-jesus-victory

N.T. Wright’s Jesus and the Victory of God reconstructs Jesus as enacting Israel’s return-from-exile story within a critical-realist method — a major Third Quest synthesis still widely engaged and contested.

[well_attested] nc-celsus

Celsus (2nd c.), preserved mainly via Origen's Contra Celsum, is an early pagan critic who treats Jesus as a historical magician/charlatan figure rather than a mythic non-entity.

[well_attested] nc-celsus-magic

Celsus portrays Jesus as a magician who learned Egyptian arts — a hostile interpretive frame for miracle traditions, not independent first-century reportage.

[well_attested] nc-celsus-true-doctrine-title

Celsus's work is conventionally titled True Doctrine (Alth's Logos); the title and primarily from Origen's quotations rather than a complete pagan manuscript.

[circumstantial] nc-celsus-virgin

Celsus (via Origen) preserves a hostile Jewish/pagan counter-narrative about Jesus' birth involving panthera traditions — reception of controversy, not primary birth documentation.

[circumstantial] nc-epictetus-christians

Epictetus (via Arrian) may allude to Christians as fearless under threat — thin and debated philosophical notice of a social type.

[well_attested] nc-galen-christians

Galen (2nd c.) makes brief remarks on Christians as a philosophical school/sect — hostile/neutral medical-philosopher notice of a known group.

[well_attested] nc-james

Josephus, Antiquities 20.200 refers to "the brother of Jesus who is called Christ, James" in the account of Ananus's execution of James — generally judged authentic.

[well_attested] nc-josephus-ant20-james-context

Josephus Ant. 20.200 places James's death in a high-priestly succession conflict under Albinus — political context that frames the "brother of Jesus called Christ" notice.

[well_attested] nc-josephus-james-minimal

Josephus Ant. 20.200 on James "the brother of Jesus who was called Christ" is widely treated as authentic and a key non-Christian control for Jesus' historical existence.

[contested] nc-josephus-tf-partial-authenticity

The majority critical position on the Testimonium Flavianum holds that Josephus wrote a shorter notice later expanded by Christian scribes; total authenticity and total forgery are minority positions.

[well_attested] nc-julian-against-galileans

Emperor Julian's Against the Galileans (4th c., fragmentary via Cyril of Alexandria) is a late imperial philosophical polemic against Christianity — reception history, not first-century biography.

[circumstantial] nc-justus-tiberias-lost

Justus of Tiberias wrote a lost history of Jewish kings and a Galilean war account known mainly via Josephus's polemic — a reminder that non-Christian Judean historiography is incompletely preserved.

[well_attested] nc-lucian

Lucian of Samosata (2nd c.) satirizes Christians and refers to their crucified sophist in Passing of Peregrinus — evidence of known Christian devotion, not independent biography.

[well_attested] nc-lucian-alexander

Lucian's Alexander the False Prophet satirizes cult founders and miracle claims in the second century — comparative evidence for how elites mocked religious innovators.

[well_attested] nc-lucian-christians-frame

Lucian's satirical frame treats Christians as gullible followers of a crucified sophist — elite mockery evidence for known Christian devotion in the 2nd century.

[well_attested] nc-lucian-peregrinus

Lucian of Samosata (2nd c.) satirizes Christians in The Passing of Peregrinus, treating Christ as a crucified “sophist” founder of a cult.

[well_attested] nc-lucian-peregrinus-christ

Lucian's Peregrinus describes Christians venerating a crucified sophist in Palestine — hostile 2nd-c. literary notice of founder memory.

[circumstantial] nc-mara

The Syriac letter of Mara bar Serapion mentions a “wise king” executed by the Jews; identification with Jesus is possible but not certain.

[circumstantial] nc-mara-bar-serapion

The Mara bar Serapion letter (Syriac; date debated, often 1st–3rd c.) may allude to a “wise king” of the Jews executed by his people — identification with Jesus is uncertain.

[circumstantial] nc-mara-serapion-genre

The Mara bar Serapion letter is a Syriac consolatory/philosophical letter whose “wise king” line is genre-constrained and chronologically uncertain — weak HJ control at best.

[circumstantial] nc-mara-serapion-limits

Mara bar Serapion's “wise king” remains an uncertain possible allusion; chronological and referent ambiguity prevent strong HJ use.

[circumstantial] nc-marcus-aurelius-christians

Marcus Aurelius (Meditations) and second-century elite literature occasionally notice Christians as a social type; such notices are thin and polemical.

[well_attested] nc-martial-juvenes

No contemporary Roman historian from Jesus' lifetime mentions him; the earliest non-Christian literary controls (Josephus, Tacitus, Pliny) are decades later.

[circumstantial] nc-nazareth-inscription

The so-called Nazareth Inscription is a Greek imperial edict against tomb violation; proposed links to early Christian empty-tomb controversy are speculative and provenance is debated.

[well_attested] nc-no-contemporary-imperial-acta

No contemporary Roman imperial acta, trial minutes, or census rolls naming Jesus of Nazareth are known to survive; non-Christian literary controls begin decades later.

[well_attested] nc-no-contemporary-jewish-literary

No surviving Jewish literary work from Jesus' lifetime (outside later Christian texts) names him; Philo is silent and the earliest Jewish controls (Josephus) are post-70.

[well_attested] nc-no-pilate-report-survives

No authentic “Acts of Pilate” or official prefectural report on Jesus is known from the first century; later Acts of Pilate / Gospel of Nicodemus texts are Christian apocrypha.

[well_attested] nc-no-roman-trial-minutes

No authentic Roman judicial minutes of Jesus' trial before Pilate are known; Gospel passion trial scenes are literary-theological narratives constrained by Roman provincial practice models.

[well_attested] nc-origen-celsus-method

Using Origen's Contra Celsum as a source for Celsus requires discounting Origen's selection, paraphrase, and rebuttal framing when reconstructing the pagan critique.

[circumstantial] nc-philos-silence-on-jesus

Philo of Alexandria (d. c. 50 CE), a prolific Jewish writer overlapping Jesus' lifetime regionally in the empire, never mentions Jesus — a silence that is expected given Philo's Egyptian diaspora focus and genre, not a decisive non-existence proof.

[verified] nc-pliny

Pliny the Younger, Epistles 10.96–97, describes early second-century Christian worship practices in Bithynia-Pontus and imperial policy under Trajan.

[verified] nc-pliny-christ-hymns

Pliny reports Christians singing hymns to Christ “as to a god” (carmen Christo quasi deo) — early 2nd-c. evidence of cultic devotion language.

[verified] nc-pliny-christians

Pliny the Younger's letter to Trajan (Ep. 10.96) describes early 2nd-century Bithynian Christians worshipping Christ “as a god” and legal policy toward them.

[verified] nc-pliny-legal-procedure

Pliny's letter details interrogation procedure, thrice-questioned persistence tests, and punishment of obstinate Christians — primary early 2nd-c. administrative procedure evidence.

[well_attested] nc-pliny-legal-template

Pliny's letter became a template cited in later Roman legal memory for handling Christians as a judicial category.

[verified] nc-pliny-trajan-reply

Trajan's reply to Pliny (Ep. 10.97) instructs not to seek Christians out but to punish the obstinate if properly accused — primary imperial policy evidence for early 2nd-c. Christian legal status.

[well_attested] nc-porphyry-against-christians

Porphry's Against the Christians (late 3rd c., fragments via Christian rebuttals) was a major philosophical critique of Christian scripture and claims — hostile reception, not first-century reportage.

[well_attested] nc-porphyry-fragments-method

Porphry's Against the Christians survives mainly in hostile Christian quotations; reconstruction requires source-critical caution about selection and paraphrase bias.

[well_attested] nc-slavonic-josephus

The Slavonic version of Josephus's Jewish War contains expansions (including Jesus-related passages) widely judged to be later Christian interpolations, not first-century Josephan text.

[circumstantial] nc-suetonius

Suetonius, Claudius 25.4, refers to disturbances in Rome impulsore Chresto — often discussed as a possible garbled reference to Christ-related conflict, but identification is uncertain.

[circumstantial] nc-suetonius-chrestus

Suetonius (Claudius 25) mentions disturbances in Rome under Claudius involving “Chrestus” — identification with Christ/Christians is possible but contested.

[circumstantial] nc-suetonius-chrestus-limits

Suetonius's Chrestus notice remains ambiguous; it cannot carry the weight of a secure independent Jesus biography.

[circumstantial] nc-suetonius-claudius-frame

Suetonius places the Chrestus disturbance in a Claudian expulsion notice about Jews in Rome — administrative anecdote, not a secure Jesus biography.

[well_attested] nc-suetonius-nero

Suetonius (Nero 16) mentions punishments of Christians under Nero as adherents of a new and mischievous superstition.

[well_attested] nc-suetonius-nero-christians

Suetonius mentions punishments of Christians under Nero in a list of Nero’s acts — brief Roman elite notice of Christian presence in Rome, not a Jesus biography.

[well_attested] nc-tacitus

Tacitus, Annals 15.44 reports that “Christus” was executed under Tiberius by the procurator Pontius Pilate and that the movement originated in Judea.

[well_attested] nc-tacitus-annals-christians-frame

Tacitus frames Christians as a hated group blamed by Nero after the Rome fire — valuable for Roman elite attitude and the Christus–Pilate notice nested in Annals 15.44.

[well_attested] nc-tacitus-christus-title

Tacitus’s use of “Christus” as a title/name and “Christians” as a group label reflects Roman awareness of the Christ-derived name by the early second century.

[well_attested] nc-tacitus-context

Tacitus Annals 15.44 places Christus’s execution under Tiberius by procurator Pontius Pilate within a Nero-era persecution narrative.

[well_attested] nc-tacitus-latin

Tacitus Annals 15.44 (Latin) states that Christus suffered the extreme penalty under Tiberius by sentence of procurator Pontius Pilate, and that the superstitio arose in Judea.

[well_attested] nc-tacitus-pilate-title

Tacitus’s “procurator” title for Pilate is a known anachronism relative to the epigraphic “prefect” title — a classic example of Roman literary imprecision that does not overturn the core notice.

[contested] nc-tacitus-sources-debate

Whether Tacitus drew on official archives, common knowledge, or Christian-adjacent rumor for Annals 15.44 remains debated; the notice’s core is still widely treated as independent of the Gospels.

[circumstantial] nc-talmud

Certain Babylonian Talmud passages are sometimes read as hostile allusions to Jesus; dating, redaction, and identification are highly contested and often late.

[circumstantial] nc-talmud-baraita-caution

Isolated Talmudic baraitot sometimes linked to Jesus are late, polemical, and methodologically unsafe as first-century biography without extreme caution.

[circumstantial] nc-talmud-dating

Rabbinic passages sometimes linked to Jesus (e.g., b. Sanhedrin traditions) are late, layered, and methodologically hazardous as first-century biography.

[contested] nc-tf

Josephus, Antiquities 18.63–64 (Testimonium Flavianum) is widely judged partly authentic with Christian interpolations; fully authentic and fully forged positions are minorities.

[contested] nc-tf-reconstructions

Major scholarly reconstructions of the Testimonium Flavianum range from a short neutral core to more expansive partial authenticity; wholesale authenticity and wholesale forgery are minority poles.

[circumstantial] nc-thallus-mediated-only

All surviving Thallus references to a darkness around the crucifixion period are mediated through later Christian citation chains; no independent Thallus manuscript survives.

[circumstantial] nc-thallus-original-lost

Thallus's histories survive only in later Christian citations (e.g., Julius Africanus via Syncellus); no independent first-century Thallus manuscript exists to verify crucifixion-darkness claims.

[circumstantial] nc-thallus-phlegon

Later Christian authors cite Thallus and Phlegon regarding a darkness or eclipse around the time of the crucifixion; the original works are lost and the citations are mediated.

[well_attested] nc-toledot-yeshu

Toledot Yeshu traditions are late medieval (and earlier oral-literary) Jewish counter-narratives about Jesus; they are reception/polemic history, not independent first-century biography.

[verified] nc-traject-pliny-trajan

Trajan's rescript to Pliny (Ep. 10.97) sets a legal policy: do not hunt Christians, punish only if proven and obstinate — Roman administrative evidence for early 2nd-c. policy.

[contested] nt-acts-we-sections

The “we” sections of Acts (first-person plural travel narrative) are a classic source-critical and textual phenomenon; explanations include eyewitness diary, literary device, or source incorporation.

[well_attested] nt-acts-western-expansions

Codex Bezae and allied “Western” witnesses often present a longer, paraphrastic Acts text; modern editors generally prefer the Alexandrian shorter form as closer to the initial text for most units.

[well_attested] nt-armenian-version

The Armenian version of the NT is an important early versional tradition useful for the apparatus, especially in relation to Greek and Syriac transmission paths.

[well_attested] nt-bohairic-coptic

The Bohairic Coptic version is a major Egyptian versional witness, later than Sahidic in many assessments, and remains valuable for the full versional apparatus.

[contested] nt-byzantine-priority

Byzantine-priority / majority-text theories remain minority positions in mainstream critical editions, which generally prefer early diverse witnesses over later numerical majority alone.

[well_attested] nt-byzantine-priority-limits

Byzantine-priority theories correctly note the medieval majority's internal coherence, but most modern editors reject equating numerical dominance with initial-text status without early genealogical support.

[verified] nt-codex-alexandrinus

Codex Alexandrinus (A 02, 5th c.) is a major early nearly complete Greek Bible witness held by the British Library.

[verified] nt-codex-sinaiticus

Codex Sinaiticus (5 01, 4th c.) is a foundational nearly complete Greek Bible major early Christian book history.

[well_attested] nt-comma-johanneum

The Comma Johanneum (1 John 5:7–8 Trinitarian expansion in some later Latin/Textus Receptus traditions) is absent from the earliest Greek manuscript tradition and is treated as secondary in modern critical editions.

[well_attested] nt-conjectural-emendation

Conjectural emendation (proposing a reading with no extant manuscript support) is rare in modern NT editions compared with classical philology; editors prefer documented variants in the apparatus.

[well_attested] nt-continuous-text-vs-lectionary

Continuous-text manuscripts and lectionaries serve different liturgical and scholarly roles; critical editions weight continuous early witnesses more heavily for initial text.

[verified] nt-coptic-versions-witness

Coptic versions (Sahidic, Bohairic, and dialects) are early Egyptian witnesses valuable for the apparatus, especially where Greek evidence is divided.

[verified] nt-correctors-hands

Corrector hands in major codices (!5 B A) document layered revision of manuscript and CBGM analyses.

[verified] nt-digital-editions

Digital critical platforms (NT.VMR, ECM online tools) enable transparent inspection of manuscript images and apparatus data beyond print editions alone.

[verified] nt-early-versions-evidence

Early versions (Latin, Syriac, Coptic) are independent witnesses that can preserve ancient readings and must be weighed with knowledge of translation technique.

[verified] nt-ecm-acts-status

The Editio Critica Maior for Acts provides the fullest modern apparatus and CBGM-informed initial text for Acts, refining older NA readings in selected units.

[verified] nt-ecm-catholic-epistles

The ECM of the Catholic Epistles pioneered CBGM application at scale and revised selected NA readings based on coherence analysis.

[verified] nt-ecm-mark-status

The Editio Critica Maior for Mark (and related CBGM publications) provides the current fullest apparatus and genealogical analysis for reconstructing Mark's initial text.

[verified] nt-ecm-method

The Editio Critica Maior (ECM) and the Coherence-Based Genealogical Method (CBGM) model manuscript relationships as a guided stemmatic network rather than a simple bipartite Alexandrian/Byzantine tree.

[well_attested] nt-ending-mark

The longer ending of Mark (16:9–20) is absent from the earliest major Greek witness editions as secondary, while shorter alternative endings also exist.

[well_attested] nt-eusebius-ch

Eusebius's Church History is an indispensable but tendentious fourth-century source for earlier Christian literature and martyrdoms; source-critical caution is mandatory.

[well_attested] nt-family-1-13

Medieval Greek manuscript families (e.g., Family 1, Family 13) show structured textual relationships useful for genealogical criticism beyond simple "majority count."

[contested] nt-farrer-hypothesis

The Farrer hypothesis (Mark !' Matthew !' Luke without Q) is the leading alternative Synoptic literary relationships.

[well_attested] nt-georgian-version

The Georgian version of the NT is an early Caucasian versional tradition that contributes independent readings to the critical apparatus in selected units.

[contested] nt-gospel-dates

Critical consensus commonly dates Mark c. 65–75 CE, Matthew and Luke c. 80–90 CE, John c. 90–100 CE — with debate bands around each.

[well_attested] nt-gothic-version

The Gothic version (Wulfila tradition) is an early Germanic translation of the NT preserving valuable versional evidence, especially where Greek witnesses diverge.

[well_attested] nt-harmonie-readings

Harmonization among Synoptic parallels is a recognized scribal tendency that can produce secondary agreements in later manuscripts.

[verified] nt-homoeoteleuton

Many NT variants arise from ordinary scribal mechanics (homoeoteleuton, dittography, orthography), not theological conspiracy.

[interpretive] nt-initial-text-vs-autograph

Modern critical editions target an initial text (Ausgangstext) that may not be identical to a single authorial autograph in every book.

[verified] nt-itacism

Itacism and vowel interchange are common Greek scribal phenomena that generate many orthographic variants without semantic change.

[contested] nt-john-historicity

John's Gospel is generally dated later than the Synoptics; its independent historical value for Jesus research is debated (high Christology vs. early tradition cores).

[verified] nt-latin-vetus-latina

The Old Latin (Vetus Latina) tradition preserves pre-Vulgate Latin translations of the NT that sometimes retain ancient readings independent of later Vulgate standardization.

[well_attested] nt-lectio-difficilior

The canons *lectio difficilior potior* and *lectio brevior potior* are traditional internal criteria in NT textual criticism; modern editors apply them with corpus-aware caution because scribes both simplify and expand.

[well_attested] nt-lectionaries

Greek lectionary manuscripts form a large late witness class used in ECM/CBGM and traditional criticism for reception history more than for earliest text alone.

[well_attested] nt-lectionary-evidence

Lectionary manuscripts preserve liturgical text forms that can retain early readings in some units while generally reflecting later Byzantine dominance.

[well_attested] nt-lectionary-text-type

Greek Gospel lectionaries form a large medieval witness class with distinctive textual profiles; they are valuable but secondary to continuous-text majuscules/minuscules for initial-text work.

[contested] nt-majority-text-debate

Majority Text / Byzantine-priority theories argue the numerically dominant medieval form best represents the initial text; most critical editors instead prefer earlier diverse witnesses weighted by genealogy and internal evidence.

[verified] nt-majuscules

Fourth–fifth century majuscules (!5 01 Sinaiticus, A 02 Alexandrinus, B 03 Vaticanus) are foundational for the critical text.

[verified] nt-mark-ending

The longer ending of Mark (16:9–20) is absent from the earliest major witnesses (!5 NA28/UBS apparatuses).

[verified] nt-ms-count

Greek New Testament continuous-text manuscripts number on the order of several thousand, with additional lectionaries and versions.

[verified] nt-na28-ubs5-status

Nestle-Aland 28th edition and UBS5 remain the standard working critical texts for most academic NT work, while ECM volumes progressively refine the initial text for specific books.

[verified] nt-na28-ubsgnt-alignment

NA28 and UBS5 share essentially the same base text for continuous reading while differing in apparatus design and intended audiences.

[verified] nt-nomina-sacra

Nomina sacra abbreviations for divine names and titles are a distinctive early Christian scribal practice visible across Greek NT manuscripts.

[well_attested] nt-origen-hexapla

Origen’s Hexapla (3rd c.) arranged Hebrew and Greek columns for comparative Old Testament textual work — a landmark of ancient textual criticism.

[contested] nt-orthodox-corruption

Bart Ehrman’s “orthodox corruption” thesis argues some early scribes altered texts in christologically charged passages; magnitude and intent remain debated.

[verified] nt-oxy-rhynchus

Oxyrhynchus papyri include important early Christian and NT fragments expanding the geographic footprint of early text transmission in Egypt.

[verified] nt-oxyrhynchus-sayings

Oxyrhynchus papyri include early Christian texts and sayings collections (e.g., P.Oxy. fragments related to Gospel of Thomas and unknown gospels) documenting Egyptian textual diversity.

[verified] nt-p-egerton

Papyrus Egerton 2 is an early non-canonical gospel fragment with Johannine and Synoptic-like episodes — evidence of diverse Jesus-narrative circulation in the second century.

[verified] nt-p45-cheaster

Papyrus P45 (Chester Beatty) is a major early substantial Gospels/Acts witness typically dated 3rd century.

[verified] nt-p45-p46-p47

Chester Beatty papyri (P45, P46, P47) are major third-century witnesses to Gospels/Acts, Paul, and Revelation respectively.

[verified] nt-p46-collection-shape

Papyrus P46 is an early substantial Pauline collection whose book order and contents inform debates on early Pauline corpus formation.

[verified] nt-p46-paul

Papyrus P46 is among the earliest substantial collections of Pauline letters (typically dated late 2nd / early 3rd century CE).

[well_attested] nt-p52

Papyrus P52 (Rylands Greek P 457) is among the earliest surviving NT fragments (John 18), paleographically dated roughly to the second century CE.

[verified] nt-p66-p75

Bodmer papyri P66 (John) and P75 (Luke/John) are major early substantial witnesses typically dated to the late 2nd / early 3rd century and foundational for early Alexandrian text studies.

[verified] nt-papyrus-discovery-curve

Twentieth–twenty-first century papyrus discoveries (Oxyrhynchus, etc.) continuously expand the early Greek NT evidence base catalogued by INTF.

[well_attested] nt-patristic-citations

Patristic citations are secondary witnesses that can preserve early readings but require careful evaluation of quoting habits and later manuscript tradition of the fathers.

[well_attested] nt-paul-dates

Undisputed Pauline letters are typically dated c. 49–58 CE and are the earliest surviving Christian literary corpus.

[well_attested] nt-pericope-adulterae

The pericope adulterae (John 7:53–8:11) is widely judged a later insertion on strong external manuscript grounds, though the story circulated early in the Latin and some Greek traditions.

[verified] nt-sahidic-coptic

The Sahidic Coptic version is among the earliest substantial Egyptian translations of the NT and a key versional witness in the critical apparatus.

[verified] nt-scribal-habits

Codicology and singular-reading studies document mechanical scribal habits (leaps, dittography, harmonization) that explain many variants without theological motive.

[verified] nt-singular-readings

Singular readings (unique to one MS) are used in scribal-habits studies to profile individual copyists without treating them as initial text.

[contested] nt-synoptic-problem

The Synoptic Problem (literary relationship of Matthew, Mark, Luke) remains an active field; Markan priority is majority, Q hypothesis is majority but contested by Farrer and other models.

[verified] nt-syriac-peshitta-witness

The Syriac Peshitta is a major early version of the NT with complex textual relationships to Greek traditions; it is essential for versional evidence and Eastern reception history.

[verified] nt-textual-criticism

Greek New Testament continuous-text manuscripts number on the order of several thousand, with additional lectionaries and versions.

[verified] nt-textus-receptus-history

The Textus Receptus is a printed early modern Greek text tradition, not identical to the earliest recoverable initial text.

[well_attested] nt-ubs-rating-letters

UBS editions assign letter ratings (A–D) to selected variants expressing editorial confidence — a pedagogical signal, not a probability in the Bayesian sense.

[verified] nt-variants

Hundreds of thousands of variant readings exist across the tradition; the vast majority are orthographic or trivial, while a minority affect meaning.

[well_attested] nt-versional-evidence

Early versions (Old Latin, Syriac, Coptic) are independent textual witnesses that can preserve early readings not always visible in later Greek majority streams.

[verified] nt-vulgate-jerome

Jerome's Vulgate became the dominant Latin Bible of the medieval West; critical editions distinguish Vulgate text forms from earlier Vetus Latina strata.

[well_attested] nt-western-non-interpolations

Westcott-Hort's "Western non-interpolations" hypothesis treated certain shorter Western readings (esp. in Luke 24) as original against longer Alexandrian forms; modern editors largely reverse or qualify that preference.

[well_attested] nt-western-text

The so-called Western text (e.g., Codex Bezae in Acts) often presents freer, paraphrastic readings that complicate simple Alexandrian/Byzantine dichotomies.

[well_attested] nt-western-text-type

The so-called Western text (e.g., Codex Bezae in Acts/Gospels) is a recognized early textual cluster with expansions and paraphrastic tendencies; its relationship to the initial text is evaluated per unit of variation.

[verified] st-1qs-penal-code

The Community Rule (1QS) includes a detailed penal code for community offenses — primary evidence of disciplined sectarian governance at Qumran-related groups.

[verified] st-4qinstruction

4QInstruction (Musa leMevin) is a major Qumran wisdom text combining sapiential and apocalyptic themes — evidence of instructional diversity in late Second Temple Judaism.

[verified] st-4qmm-t

4QMMT (Miqsat Ma'ala leTorah) presents halakhic rulings distinguishing a Qumran Jewish authorities — primary evidence of legal sectarianism before 70 CE.

[verified] st-alexander-jannaeus

Alexander Jannaeus (Hasmonean king-priest) is documented in Josephus and coins; his reign illustrates internal Judean conflict before Roman dominance.

[well_attested] st-antonia-fortress

The Antonia Fortress adjacent to the Temple Mount is described by Josephus as a key Roman military foothold in Jerusalem.

[verified] st-caligula-statue-crisis

The Caligula (Gaius) statue crisis (c. 39–41 CE) — the planned installation of the emperor's image in the Jerusalem Temple — is documented by Philo and Josephus as a near-catastrophe for Judean–Roman relations.

[verified] st-coinage-revolt

Jewish revolt coinage (First Revolt 66–70 CE; Bar Kokhba 132–135 CE) provides dated material propaganda and economic evidence independent of Christian texts.

[verified] st-community-rule

Qumran sectarian texts (e.g., Community Rule 1QS, War Scroll 1QM, Pesharim) document a Jewish movement with distinctive purity, calendar, and eschatology in the late Second Temple period.

[well_attested] st-copper-scroll

The Copper Scroll (3Q15) from Qumran lists alleged treasure deposits in Hebrew — a unique metal DSS text whose historical treasure map status remains debated.

[verified] st-dss

Dead Sea Scrolls (discovered 1946–1956) preserve Hebrew Bible books and sectarian texts from roughly the third century BCE to first century CE.

[well_attested] st-dss-books

Among biblical DSS copies, Psalms, Deuteronomy, Isaiah, Exodus, and Genesis are among the most frequently attested books; Esther is not securely attested at Qumran.

[verified] st-elephantine

Elephantine papyri document a Jewish military colony in Egypt (5th c. BCE) with a local temple of YHW and correspondence with Jerusalem/Samaria authorities.

[contested] st-essene-hypothesis

The Essene hypothesis linking Qumran/DSS to Josephus's Essenes remains a leading but contested model among alternatives (Jerusalem library, multi-group deposits).

[well_attested] st-essene-josephus-limits

Josephus's Essene descriptions are literary ethnography with idealizing features; equating every detail with Qumran archaeology is methodologically unsafe.

[verified] st-hasmonean-period

The Hasmonean period (2nd–1st c. BCE) established Jewish political autonomy later dismantled under Roman client and provincial rule — essential pre-history for first-century Judea.

[verified] st-herod-antipas

Herod Antipas ruled Galilee and Perea as tetrarch (4 BCE–39 CE); Josephus and coins document his rule and cities (Tiberias; Sepphoris reconstruction).

[verified] st-herod-coinage-propaganda

Herodian coinage avoids human portraits in Judean issues while displaying Greek-style symbols and inscriptions — primary numismatic evidence of cultural negotiation under client kingship.

[contested] st-herod-great-death

Herod the Great's death is commonly dated 4 BCE (with minority 1 BCE arguments), framing the terminus for Matthew's birth narrative chronology.

[well_attested] st-herod-josephus-portrait

Josephus's portrait of Herod the Great mixes administrative achievement with tyranny narratives shaped by sources and Flavian context — primary but tendentious.

[verified] st-herod-temple

Herod's expansion of the Jerusalem Temple Mount is archaeologically and literarily documented (Josephus; Western Wall / Temple Mount retaining architecture).

[verified] st-herod-temple-expansion

Herod's Temple Mount expansion created a massive platform whose retaining architecture remains archaeologically visible (Western Wall, etc.).

[well_attested] st-high-priest-politics

High-priestly appointment and deposition under Herodian and Roman authorities show the Temple leadership's political entanglement with imperial power.

[well_attested] st-isaiah-stability

Comparison of 1QIsaC (c. 2nd–1st century BCE) with the medieval Masoretic Text shows mostly orthographic and minor variants.

[well_attested] st-josephus-antiquities-preface

Josephus's preface to Jewish Antiquities presents the work as a full history of the Jewish people for Greco-Roman readers, with apologetic and pedagogical aims.

[well_attested] st-josephus-apion

Josephus's Against Apion defends Jewish antiquity and customs against Greco-Roman critics — primary evidence of late first-century Jewish apologetic discourse.

[well_attested] st-josephus-biases

Josephus writes as a Flavian client and aristocratic Judean survivor; his portraits of groups and events require bias-aware reading.

[verified] st-josephus-corpus

Flavius Josephus (late first century CE) is a principal non-Christian Jewish historian for Herodian and early Roman Judea.

[well_attested] st-josephus-jewish-war-structure

Josephus's Jewish War is structured as a Flavian-era history of the revolt with preface, campaign narrative, and temple destruction climax — genre and patronage shape its presentation.

[well_attested] st-josephus-life-autobiography

Josephus's Life (Vita) is an autobiographical defense of his conduct in the Galilee war, written against Justus of Tiberias and other critics.

[well_attested] st-josephus-war-preface

Josephus's preface to the Jewish War frames his work as a corrective to other accounts and as written for both Roman and Jewish audiences under Flavian patronage.

[verified] st-lxx-textual

The Septuagint often preserves readings that differ from the medieval Masoretic Text; some align with Qumran Hebrew witnesses.

[verified] st-mikvaot

Stepped ritual baths (mikva'ot) are archaeologically widespread in late Second Temple Judea and Galilee, evidencing purity practice infrastructure.

[verified] st-mikveh-galilee-density

Late Second Temple Galilee shows widespread mikva'ot in villages and towns, evidencing purity infrastructure beyond Jerusalem alone.

[verified] st-mikveh-jerusalem-density

Jerusalem shows an exceptionally high density of late Second Temple mikva'ot, reflecting intensified purity practice among residents and pilgrims.

[verified] st-mikveh-purity

Widespread miqva'ot in late Second Temple Judea/Galilee evidence purity practice infrastructure relevant to baptism and purity language in early sources.

[well_attested] st-mishnah-context

The Mishnah (c. 200 CE redaction) and related Tannaitic literature preserve legal memory of Second Temple practice but are post-70 literary products requiring critical use for pre-70 reconstruction.

[well_attested] st-parties

Josephus and later rabbinic memory describe Pharisees, Sadducees, and Essenes as major Jewish schools; exact social demographics remain reconstructed.

[well_attested] st-pharisee-josephus-portrait

Josephus's portrait of Pharisees (popular influence, legal expertise, belief in fate/resurrection per his schemes) is primary but tendentious and must be read against his elite agenda.

[well_attested] st-pharisee-popularity

Josephus claims Pharisees had popular influence; critical historians treat this as tendentious but still evidence of a major school's social role.

[well_attested] st-pharisees-josephus

Josephus's descriptions of Pharisees, Sadducees, and Essenes are primary but tendentious; social realities were more complex than three-school schemes.

[verified] st-philo

Philo of Alexandria provides contemporary diaspora Jewish philosophical and exegetical context for the early first century CE.

[well_attested] st-philo-allegory

Philo of Alexandria develops extensive allegorical exegesis of the Torah for a Hellenistic Jewish audience in the early first century.

[verified] st-philo-embassy-gaius

Philo's Embassy to Gaius narrates the Alexandrian Jewish crisis and the Caligula Temple statue threat from a contemporary diaspora Jewish perspective.

[well_attested] st-philo-migration-abraham

Philo's treatises on Abraham (e.g., On the Migration of Abraham) exemplify allegorical Torah exegesis for a Hellenistic Jewish audience in the early first century.

[well_attested] st-philo-special-laws

Philo's Special Laws treatises expound Torah commandments for a Hellenistic Jewish audience, combining literal and allegorical exegesis.

[verified] st-pompey-63

Pompey's intervention in Judea (63 BCE) brought Hasmonean civil conflict under Roman arbitration and began lasting Roman overlordship.

[verified] st-prefecture

Roman Judea after 6 CE was administered by equestrian prefects (later procurators) based primarily at Caesarea, with troops and judicial powers including capital cases in practice.

[well_attested] st-qumran-calendar

Some DSS calendrical texts promote a 364-day solar calendar differing from later rabbinic lunar-solar practice — evidence of calendar diversity.

[well_attested] st-qumran-cemetery

The Qumran cemetery and associated settlement archaeology frame debates about who produced/used the Dead Sea Scrolls and the site's sectarian character.

[verified] st-qumran-pesharim

Qumran pesharim (continuous commentaries) interpret prophetic books as fulfilled in the community's history — primary evidence of Second Temple exegetical method.

[contested] st-roman-census-practices

Roman provincial censuses and tax registrations are documented empire-wide; Luke's census of Quirinius is a specific chronological crux relative to Herod's death.

[verified] st-roman-client-kings

Rome governed Judea via client kings (Herod, Archelaus) and later equestrian prefects — dual administrative models shape Gospel political settings.

[well_attested] st-sadducees-josephus

Josephus's descriptions of Sadducees emphasize aristocratic temple-associated elites denying fate and (per him) resurrection — tendentious but indispensable.

[well_attested] st-salome-alexandra

Salome Alexandra's reign (Hasmonean queen) is documented in Josephus as a period of Pharisaic influence before dynastic collapse into Roman arbitration.

[verified] st-samaria-papyri

The Wadi Daliyeh (Samaria) papyri document mid-4th-century BCE legal/administrative life under late Persian / early Hellenistic rule in Samaria.

[verified] st-synagogue-inscriptions

Dedicatory inscriptions (e.g., Theodotos inscription) document pre-70 synagogue buildings used for reading Torah and hospitality.

[contested] st-synagogue-origins

The institutional origins and pre-70 function of "synagogues" remain debated; archaeological assembly buildings and literary references do not form a single simple type.

[well_attested] st-temple-economy

The Jerusalem Temple system involved tithes, offerings, and currency exchange for worshippers — a documented economic-religious complex in Josephus and later rabbinic memory.

[verified] st-temple-scroll

The Temple Scroll (11QTa) from Qumran presents an idealized Temple plan and purity legislation distinct from the later Mishnah — evidence of alternative legal imaginations in Second Temple Judaism.

[well_attested] st-temple-tax

The half-shekel Temple tax and related fiscal practices are documented in Josephus, Matthew 17 tradition, and later rabbinic memory.

[verified] st-temple-warning-inscription

The Temple balustrade warning inscription (soreg) forbids Gentiles to enter the inner courts on pain of death — a primary Greek epigraphic control for Temple spatial purity rules.

[well_attested] st-therapeutae-philos

Philo's De Vita Contemplativa describes the Therapeutae, a contemplative Jewish community in Egypt with communal study and allegorical exegesis — evidence of diaspora Jewish diversity.

[well_attested] st-tyrian-shekel-temple-tax

Tyrian silver shekels were widely used for the Jerusalem Temple tax in the late Second Temple period because of consistent silver purity — a numismatic-fiscal context for money-changer scenes.

[well_attested] st-war-scroll

The War Scroll (1QM) and related DSS texts depict eschatological battle ideology within a Second Temple Jewish sectarian milieu.

[well_attested] st-yahad-messianic-rule

The Rule of the Congregation (1QSa) and related yahad texts describe messianic banquet and leadership structures — evidence of dual-messiah / messianic expectation diversity at Qumran.